



PREFACE

The objective of this work book is to encourage students to learn and practice English as a tool of communication and to enable them to learn by doing. It looks language from students' point of view, and guides them through co-operative learning in inductive and deductive approach. 'Standard English Grammar and Technical Writing Work Book' is designed in a comprehensive manner by keeping practical difficulties of the students in mind. The contents of this book include solved examples and exercises to solve, it strictly follows the English Language pattern and it is perfectly based on the St. Joseph's Evening College's English examinations and syllabi pattern, so that students can get everything at one place in a well-defined manner to achieve language skills and to score high marks in the examinations.

I am confident that the book will help all the students because of its pragmatic approach. This book would not have been possible, without the background help of Fr. Maxim Dias S.J, the Principal St. Joseph's Evening College, and Prof. Joy Alex, the Vice Principal St. Joseph's Evening College. Special thanks due to Mr. Mukesh Soni, Assistant Professor, Dayananda Sagar Institutions and, Mrs. Saranya Francis, for checking this book for no error.

I will be grateful to you for all the suggestions for the improvement of this second edition book and it will be appreciatively acknowledged.

- Author
Diwakar P Yadav



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INTRODUCTION

The word 'Grammar' has been defined differently by different scholars and schools of linguists. As to its origin, the word Grammar is derived from the Greek word 'Grammatical' meaning 'The art of writing'. Generally, we now use the word 'Grammar' for the whole study of a language.

The Greeks considered grammar to a branch of philosophy concerned with the art of writing, but by the middle ages grammar came to be regarded as a set of rules, in the form of a text book, telling us about the correct use of language i.e., normative and prescriptive rules in order to set up a standard of correct usage. Thus grammar came to be regarded both the art and the science of language and till 19th century the grammarian was the law-giver. But now no modern linguist will accept this definition of grammar any longer.

Most linguists agree that grammar should be descriptive. Grattan and Gurrey agree that the grammar of a language is not a list of rules imposed upon its speakers by scholastic authorities. The modern linguists regard grammar as an inventory of units such as phonemes, morphemes, words, lexical categories, phrases, and clauses. In the words of an American linguist, 'Nelson Francis,' "Grammar is the study of the organization of words into various combinations often representing many layers of the structure such as phrases, sentences, and complete utterances."

Grammar, as has been often said, given rules for combining words to form sentences. There are, therefore, two divisions of grammar: words (morphology) and sentences (syntax). Within linguistics, grammar is thus normally used in a technical sense to distinguish it chiefly from phonology i.e. the study of the sounds of a language, and semantics i.e. the study of meaning.

A complete grammar should also include, therefore, include the details of pronunciation transcription (into a phonetic script) and orthography.

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Grammatical Units

Sentences, clauses, phrases, words, and morphemes are grammatical units. Traditional grammar has been built on the word as the basic unit. But the linguists say that the basic of language is neither the word nor the sentence but, the utterance. Let us now describe the units of the language:

The Sentence:

There are so many definitions of a sentence

- “We generally define a sentence as a word or a set of words followed by a pause, revealing an intelligible purpose.” 'A.H. Gardinar'
- “A sentence is an independent linguistic form, not included by virtue of any grammatical construction in any larger linguistic form.” 'Bloom field' In short, a sentence is by definition grammatically complete. It is usually marked in writing by final punctuation, full stop, question mark, exclamation mark or semicolon.

'Grammar thus operates between the upper limit of the sentence and lower limit of the morpheme or minimal grammatical unit. Between these limits structures are given titles as clause, phrase and word. Word, of course, in all languages appear as a particular stable element and serves as a basic grammatical unit.

The Word: The word has been defined differently, e.g. as speech, utterance, verbal expressions.

The Bible says: “In the beginning was the word, and the word was with God, and the word was God.”

Another well-known definition of the word is: “A word may be defined as the union of a particular meaning with a particular complex of sounds capable of a particular grammatical employment.” This is a semantic definition of the word.

However when we try to define the word grammatically, Bloomfield's definition of the word as 'a minimal free form' comes first to our mind.

The Morpheme: It is the minimal grammatical unit e.g. the four constituents of the word 'Unfaithfulness (un-faith-ful-ness) are morphemes.

The Phrase: “Any group of words with its own subject and predicate is called a phrase.” 'John Lyons'

The Clause: “Any group of words which does not have its own subject and predicate, if it is included in a large sentence is called a clause.” John Lyons



Grammatical categories

The term 'Category' is generally employed to mean a 'class or a set of any group of elements recognized in the description of language. Sometimes it refers to 'parts of speech', but sometimes we restrict its use to such features as are associated with 'parts of speech' as a person, tense, mood, gender, number, and case. 'Parts of speech' are conveniently referred to as Primary Grammatical Category and 'Case' are called Secondary Grammatical Category, whereas the traditional synthetic notions such as 'Subject', 'Predicate', 'Object', 'Complement', are Grammatical Functions or 'Functional Category.'

Primary category i.e. Part of Speech. They are Noun, Pronoun, Adjective, Adverb, Verb, Preposition, Conjunction/Linkers, as also Article, Modal, and Demonstrative. But traditionally we speak of eight parts of speech in English: noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, conjunction and interjection.

Functional categories:

Subject and Predicate- Every sentence is made up of two parts: a subject and a predicate. The subject is necessarily a noun or a pronoun (standing for a noun), predicate falls into one of the three types:

- Intransitive verb with or without a complement.
e.g. He runs fast, he sleeps, he tries
- Transitive verb with one or two objects.
e.g. she writes a letter (one object), He gave me a book (two objects)
- Transitive verb with one object and one complement.
e.g. They made him king (him-object) (king-complement)

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The Sentence

A Sentence is a group of words that gives full meaning. Words with proper order make them good sentences with the supply of appropriate punctuation.

Examples:

1. Andrew is a boy.
2. An apple is a fruit.
3. Rose is a flower.
4. Tiger is an animal.

Parts of a sentence

There are two parts in a sentence namely

1. Subject
2. Predicate

Note: Subject

1. Proper Noun; Ram, Kamala, Bangalore
2. Common Noun; boy, girl, box
3. Noun phrase; those fruits, these books
4. Personal Pronouns; I, we, you, he, she, it, they

Demonstrative Pronouns

Subject	Predicate
Bangalore	is a big city
Children	are fond of sweets
This	is made in China
We	are teachers
That	is not gold

Kinds of Sentences

There are four kinds of sentences namely

1. Assertive Sentence: An Assertive sentence makes a statement, Statements are declarations or assertions. A sentence which is a statement can be either affirmative or negative.

Examples

1. He is a teacher. (Affirmative)



2. Teachers teach lessons.
3. She is not a doctor. (Negative)
4. Samuel is not a teacher.
5. There is no smoke without fire.

2. Imperative Sentence: An Imperative sentence expresses command or request, suggestions, instructions etc.

Examples:

A. Commands

1. Sit straight.
2. Don't make noise.
3. Go to school regularly.
4. Don't cheat others.

B. Requests

1. Please help me to do this work.
2. Kindly grant me two days leave.
3. Please come to my house.

3. Interrogative sentences: An Interrogative sentence asks question or makes enquiries. In questions the word order changes and questions end with question mark.

Two types of Interrogatives/Questions

1. Yes/No Type questions

Examples:

1. Do you like this pen?
2. Are you well or ill?

Note: Yes or No type Questions begin with the following helping verbs

(Yes/No Type)

1. Am -Am I doing the work perfectly?
2. Is - Is it a pen?

2. 'wh' words (what, who/m, whose, where, when, which, why, how) are pronouns which help to ask questions. They stand as the subject of the verb.

They are called Interrogative Pronouns.

1. Why did you come late?
2. What do you want?

4. Exclamatory Sentences: An exclamatory sentence expresses strong feelings. It begins with 'what' or 'how'; the exclamatory phrase consists of 'what' or 'how' plus a noun or noun phrase. It ends with an exclamation mark.

Ex: 1. How beautiful the rose is! 2. What a beautiful flower the rose is!



Basic Sentence Patterns

The English sentence-patterns are built around the verb. Taking the verb as the key, the patterns can be arranged in five master groups; one containing three main items and two containing four main items.

1. S-V
2. S-V-O
3. S-V-C
4. S-V-O-O
5. S-V-O-C

Thus:

1. Subject and Verb:

S	V
She	played.
The other old woman	sat on a chair.

1. Subject, Verb and Object:

S	V	O
She	made	a box.
A fish	could not swallow	all the bait.

1. Subject, Verb and Compliment/Subject-Complement:

S	V	O
They	were	innocent.
The weather	became	very stormy.

4. Subject, Verb, Object, and Object

S	V	O	O
The minister	gave	him	a medal.
The professor	had been asking	his students	several questions.



1. Subject, Verb, Object, Complement/Object Complement:

S	V	O	OC
The illness	made	her	bad-tempered
The other woman	elected	him	chairman.

Substitutions

If the pattern is the simple two-item model, S-V, then two sets of substitutions are possible. First, variations may be entered on the first item:

S	V
She	fought
The man	
One of the teachers	
None of them	

Making a total of five sentences

In a three item pattern, for example S-V-O, three successive substitutions are possible.

First, variation

S	V	O
He	made	a box.
The thief		
One of the students		
The carpenter		
A man		

Second, variation:

S	V	O
He	made	a box.
	found	
	bought	
	brought	
	wanted	

**Third, variation**

S	V	O
He	made	a box several copies two boxes one of this the other chair

Each variation provides five sentences on the pattern. The first and the second variations together provide 25 sentences, such as: All three variations together provide $5 \times 5 \times 5 = 125$ sentences all on the same pattern. In a fourth item pattern, the number of sentences that can be presented in the table form is yet further increased:

S	V	O	O
The minister	gave	him	a medal

S	V	O	O
The leader	gave	him	his medal
He	showed	me	nothing
I	offered	the old man	a gold ring
The commanding officer	sent	the postman	a letter of thanks
The victorious man	refused	my brother	a robe of office
	promised		

Using all the possible combinations presented in the table, we get $5 \times 6 \times 5 \times 5 = 750$ sentences of all the same general pattern or construction.



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Verbs & Tenses

In Latin a word was called 'Verbum'. The English word 'Verb' has been derived from 'Verbum'. Thus verb means 'the word' or 'the most important word' in a sentence. A Verb is a word that tells something about a person place, animal or thing. Whatever a subject does, it is the verb that tells us of the action, state and possession of the subject

Examples:

1. Mohan is a good boy.
2. He studies well.
3. She has a little sugar in those tins.

Main verbs are those verbs that can stand on their own in sentences. They do not need the help of another verb to make a sentence meaningful. A main verb directly tells you what the subject of a sentence does. Main verbs are also called lexical verbs. They can be in present or past tense forms.

Each main verb has six different forms:

1	V ^o	First form/Root Form/Base Form Present Tense Form	Write
2	V ^{ed}	Second Form Past Tense Form	Wrote
3	V ^{en}	Third Form Past Participle Form	Written
4	V ^s	Fourth Form s/es/ies/Simple Present Tense Form (Third person singular)	Writes
5	V ^{ing}	Fifth Form Continuous Form	Writing
6	To V ^o	Sixth Form Infinitive Form	To write

1. Transitive and Intransitive verbs

Transitive Verb: The verb that takes an object in a sentence is called Transitive verb. The object usually answers the questions what or whom. An action verb with no direct object is transitive.

**Examples:**

1. John baked some cookies.

(Verb) (Object)

2. She drove the car.

3. The boy kicked the ball.

All of the verbs in the above sentences are transitive because an object is receiving the action of the verb

An Intransitive verb does not take any object in a sentence. It answers the question how or where or when. Intransitive verbs are action verbs, they do not have an object receiving action.

Example:

1. Birds fly in the sky.

3. The glass fell.

2. The boy runs fast.

4. She laughed.

2. Auxiliary Verbs

Primary Auxiliaries: Primary auxiliaries are called helping verbs. They help the main verbs to form certain tenses like continuous and perfect, to make negatives form, questions question tags, and passive voice. They change their form according to the number and person of the subject.

Finite Verbs: Verbs which have the past or the present form are called Finite Verbs. Finite verbs are limited by tense, number and person, they are action words.

Example:

- David plays the piano.
- My sister spoke French.

Non-Finite Verbs: Non-Finite verbs are the forms of the verb which function as nouns or adjectives. They cannot themselves perform the full function of a finite verb.

The words 'to learn', 'walking', 'seeing' are forms of verbs called non-finite forms of verbs.

Example:

- Leaving home can be very traumatic.
- Leave immediately when you are asked to do so.

The Infinitive : To + Verb

- Somu buys a computer.
- Somu goes to shop to buy computer.



In the first sentence the verb is 'buys'. It is called a finite verb because it is limited by tense, person and number. In the second sentence 'to buy' is not finite verb because it is not limited by number, person and tense.

The form of the finite verb changes according to number and person. But the form of 'to buy' remains unchanged. It is not limited by person or number. 'To buy' names the action denoted by the verb. 'To buy' is an infinitive. If the verb is followed by to, it is denoted as to infinitive.

Auxiliaries (Helping Verbs)

Auxiliaries are of two kinds namely:

- | | |
|--------------------------|----|
| 1. Primary auxiliaries | 11 |
| 2. Secondary auxiliaries | 13 |

Total **24(Finite Auxiliary Verbs)**

1. Primary Auxiliaries.

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|---|
| a. 'Be' form –am, is, are, was, were | 5 |
|--------------------------------------|---|

Non-finites- been, being, be

- | | |
|--------------------------------|---|
| b. 'have' form- has, have, had | 3 |
|--------------------------------|---|

Non-finite- having

- | | |
|------------------------------|---|
| c. 'do' form – do, does, did | 3 |
|------------------------------|---|

(Non-finites) doing, done

Total **11**

Primary auxiliaries are used

a. To make continuous tense forms :

Examples: **(Auxiliaries)**

I	am/was
We You They	are/ were
He She	is /was

reading a story book


b) To make perfect tense form:
Examples:
(Auxiliaries)

I We You	have had
He She	has had

read the novel

c) To frame yes/no type or Non 'wh' questions:

Do Did	I, we you, they
Does Did	he she

read the story book?

When

Do Did	I, we you, they
Does Did	he she

read the story book?

d) To form negative sentences:

I We You they	do did
He She	does did

not read the story book



e) To form passive voice

A mango	is was has been had been	eaten by	me us you
Mangoes	are were have been had been	eaten by	him her them

f) To form question tags:

1. Mohan studies well, doesn't he?
2. Sarala told a story, didn't she?
3. I am speaking truth, aren't I? (Special Question Tag)

2. Secondary Auxiliaries

- | | |
|--|------------|
| 1. Can, Could | -2 |
| 2. Will, Would | -2 |
| 3. Shall, Should | -2 |
| 4. May, Might | -2 |
| 5. Must, Ought, Used to, Need and Dare | -5 |
| Total | -13 |

Note:

1. Secondary auxiliaries are also called **modal auxiliaries** or **modals**

The modals are used to express some attitude like:

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| 1. Permission | 5. Necessity |
| 2. Possibility | 6. Obligation |
| 3. Request | 7. Ability |
| 4. Probability | 8. Promise etc |

**Examples: (According to the attitudes)**

1. May I come in, sir?
2. It may rain today.
3. Could you lend me a dictionary please?
4. My friend bought a plot in Bangalore in the year 1990. He might have got a house built in the year 2006.
5. We should work hard to earn money.
6. We must be obedient to our parents.
7. I can buy a car next month.
8. I will surely lend you Rs 5000/- tomorrow.

Note 1:

1. All 24 auxiliaries can be combined with (the short form of not) **n't** in the negative form, which becomes informal usage.

Examples: isn't, aren't, wasn't, weren't, don't, doesn't, didn't, hasn't, shan't (shall not), won't (will not) etc.

Note 2:

1. They are also called anomalous or special verbs because they are the only verbs that come before the subject in questions.

Examples:

1. Is Ram working hard?
2. Have you been to Bangalore?

Many languages have verb forms with special endings or show these different ways of looking upon an activity or state. These changes of form in conjugation of a verb are called moods. Modals are those verbs, which tell us about the mood of the person or the state of action.

Some uses of Modal Auxiliaries

Will → is used to denote the future time

Example: I will go to Delhi tomorrow.

It is used to express polite requests and invitations

Example: Will you please bring a glass of water?

To express decision

Example : I will meet him tomorrow.

Would : 'Would' is used to refer to future time from the point of view of the past.



Examples:

a) Would : To express an imaginary situation

Example: I would have gone to Delhi yesterday.

I would have been with my parents.

b) Would: To express polite request

Example: Would you mind closing the door?

Would you please help me?

c) Would is used after wish

Example: I wish it would stop raining.

d) Would with the adverbs rather and sooner

Example: He would rather read a biography than a book on history.

The girl would sooner become a rich.

Shall:

a) To express promise

Example: I shall return your book.

b) To express an order or command

Example: You shall pay for breaking the rule.

c) To express instructions

Example: How shall we carry out the final match?

d) To make offers and suggestions

Examples: Shall I drive you to the bus station?

Shall we meet at the college?

Should:

a) It is used to express prohibition

b) It is used to show duty

c) It is used to offer advice

Example: One should be loyal to his country.

You should have brought your book.

You should not smoke in the theatre.

Can:

a) 'Can' is used to show ability, to ask for permission, and to grant permission

Can I use your phone?



Yes, you can use my phone.

I can get good marks in my exams.

Could:

'Could' is the past tense of can

a) It is used to show past ability.

b) It is used to ask permission.

Rita could run fast.

Could I speak?

c) To express a request

Could you go with your friend to the hospital?

d) Could with the Present Perfect Tense

I could have helped my brother yesterday.

May:

a) May is used to show possibility.

b) To ask permission and to give permission.

India may win the match.

May I come in?

You may use my book.

Might:

It is the past tense of May.

a) It is used to show slight possibility.

b) To show past possibility.

Examples:

India might have won the match.

It might have rained yesterday.

Must:

a) Must is used for compulsive advice.

Reema must study hard.

We must get through the examination.

b) to express obligation

You must report for duty tomorrow morning.



Need: 'Need' can be used as a transitive verb.

a) It is used to show necessity.

Example: India needs to improve its relationship with Pakistan.

b) To express absence of obligation

Example: He need not go to the doctor.

Ought:

a) To express duty or obligations

He ought to be here.

I ought to read carefully.

b) 'Ought' + the perfect infinitive

I ought to have told him the truth.

People ought to have been more generous.

Dare:

It is used to show courage, to challenge or to defy.

Example: My friend dared me to touch the snake.

The boy dared the girl to swim across the river.

Used to:

It refers to past habits, discontinued habits, routine in the past or conditions.

Example: She used to walk every day. He used to go to school.

Tenses

It is important that you do not mix up time and tense. Time is same for everybody: past, present, future. But tense of verbs do not always fit into.

PRESENT TENSE

I. Present Simple Tense

To express universal truths

1. The earth rotates on its own axis.
2. Mosquitoes cause malaria.

To express habitual action

1. Cats drink milk.

To express actions in the immediate present

1. See how it looks!
2. I agree with you.
3. I rely on your support.

**To express the present period**

1. My brother studies in a college.
2. Our house has a large window.

To express a future fixed action

1. The match starts at 5 p. m.

In conditional clauses

1. If he works hard, he will succeed.
2. Unless he runs, he will not win.

II. Present Continuous Tense

Subject + 'Be' form (Present) + Main Verb+ ing+ Object

Action in progress at the time of speaking

1. Someone is knocking at the door.
2. Why are you sitting at my desk?

Temporary situations

1. What is he doing these days?
2. He is teaching English at the University.

Planned future actions

1. We are going to Delhi next year.
2. I am meeting my aunt tomorrow.

Repeated actions

1. He is always insisting on regularity.
2. She is always helping the poor.

III. Present Perfect Tense

Subject+ 'Have' form (Present) + III form of Main Verb (Past Participle) + Object

To describe actions or events beginning in the past and continuing up to the present moment

a) The Present Perfect Tense suggests the events taking place up to the present.

I have read fifty pages so far.

Have you ever seen a tiger?

b) The Present Perfect Tense expresses a past action, the results of which still continue as:

I have known her for ten years

She has been ill since last Saturday.



c) The Present Perfect Tense with since and for:

Since and for are often used with The Present Perfect Tense to refer to a period of time up to the present

Ex. Abha has been here since 4 o'clock (and she is still here)

Ex. He lived in the hostel for two years (but he does not live there now)

3. For actions occurring at unspecified time

a) The Present Perfect Tense for recent action:

She has just gone out.

He has not yet completed it.

b) The Present Perfect Tense for repeated or habitual actions

John has practiced the game regularly.

IV. Present Perfect Continuous Tense

Subject + 'Have' form + 'Be' form (nonfinite) + Main verb + ing + Object

1. For action in progress throughout a period

She has been dancing here since morning. (Still dancing)

2. With verbs suggesting continuity

I have been working for ten years. (I am still working)

3. For repeated actions

I have been knocking at the door.

4. For an unfinished action

He has been building the house for two years now.

PAST TENSE

I. Simple Past Tense

The Simple Past Tense is used in:

1. The Present Perfect Tense is normally used when we talk about events, actions or situations which occurred in the past and are now finished

a) Which may have happened recently or which may have happened in the distant past:

She left home a week ago.

Ashoka was a great king.

b) When time reference is given

He finished his work last week.



2. The immediate past

This tense is used without time reference to describe something that had happened a very short time ago.

Who left the door opened?

3. Past Habits

The Simple Past is used to describe past habits.

She drank ten cups of coffee a day till last month.

II. Past Continuous Tense

Subject + 'Be' form (Past) + Main Verb + ing + Object

1. Actions in progress in the past

- a) **The Past Continuous Tense is used to describe past situations or actions that were in progress sometime in the past.**

Raju was living abroad in 2006, so he missed the elections.

- b) **Often, it is not known whether the action was completed or not.**

He was working on his project last year.

2. Actions which began before something else happened.

When I was leaving the house, the phone rang.

3. Parallel Actions

While I was mowing the lawns, my mother was cooking dinner.

4. Polite inquiries

I was wondering if you could give me lift.

III. Past Perfect Tense

Subject + 'Have' form (Past) + III form Main Verb (Past Participle) + Object

1. The main use of the Past Perfect is when two events take place in close sequence.

The patient had died when the doctor arrived.

2. Unfulfilled hopes and wishes

I had hoped to send a telegram to him, but I could not send it.

IV. Past Perfect Continuous Tense

Subject + 'Have' form (Past) + 'Be' form (nonfinite) + Main verb + ing + Object

1. Actions in progress throughout a period

She was very tired. She had been typing all day.

2. Repeated Actions

I was annoyed. Ramesh had been speaking to me every day for a week.



FUTURE TIME

I. Simple future time

Simple future time is used in:

1. Prediction of Events

Prices of food products will rise again next year.

We shall see you next month.

2. 'Will' in formal style of scheduled events

The function will take place at St. Joseph's auditorium on 10th June.

3. 'Will/shall' to express hope

I hope she will get good marks.

II. Future Continuous Time

The Future Continuous Time is used in:

1. Actions in progress in future

Our relatives will be arriving at 4 pm.

2. Arrangements and Plans

I will be reaching Otty on Sunday.

Exercises (Time and Tense)

1. The Simple Present and Present Continuous. Fill in the blanks with right form of verb:

a. Kamala and Vimala.....(wait) outside a telephone booth. Inside the booth

Suresh(dial) a number.

Kamala: You..... (know) that boy?

Vimala: Yes, he is my brother's friend. He..... (phone) his dear wife everyday from this booth.

b. A bus conductor (get) more exercise than a bus driver. The driver just (sit) in his cab but the conductor (stand) and (walk) about and (run) up and down the stairs.

c. Imagine that you(travel) by train in a crowded compartment. One of the passengers (read) a newspaper; another (do) a crossword puzzle. Suddenly the train stops with a jerk and your luggage (fall) off the rack on to somebody's toes.



2. The Simple Present, Simple Past and Past Continuous

- a. "What did you (do) between 9 a.m and 10.30 a.m yesterday?"
says the policeman. "I (clean) the house", said Sam.
- b. Most of the boys (listen) to the teacher but a few (whisper) to each other and Rahul (read) a novel during class hours.
- c. What (do) you when the door bell rang?
I (write) my assignment.
And what (is) you (do) when you (hear) the bell?
I (go) to answer it.

3. The Present Perfect and Simple Past

- a. I (buy) a new dictionary last week, but I
(not+give) my old dictionary to anyone yet.
- b. How long you (be) at B.E.L?
I (be) there for two months. And what You (do)
before that? Before that I (work) for Simson & Co.
- c. The Principal (look) up as he (come) in. "You (be)
late every morning this month", said he.

4. The Simple Past, the Past Perfect, the Past Continuous

- a. When the old lady (return) to her flat she (see) at once the burglars..... (break) in during her absence, because the front door (open) and everything in the flat (be) upside down. The burglars themselves (leave) because a cigarette was still burning on an ornamental table.
Probably they (hear)
the lift coming up and(run) down the stairs.
- b. When I (ask) him what he(do), he (say) that



he.....(drop) a rupee coin outside the door and (look) for it.

- c. When I (get up) the next morning he(be) still there,
and I.....(wonder) whether he(stay) all night or if he (go)
away and (come) back.

5. Fill in the blanks with the appropriate tense forms of verbs given in brackets:

- a. One evening, when Elizabeth was 17, she (hear) a sermon preached by an
American Quaker, which (change) the whole course of her life.
She (determine) then to dedicate herself to the service of God.
- b. The traditional dress of a Soliga(be) very simple. Men wear a small Jotra.
Wearing shirts(have) become the fashion now and a shirt(be+call)
a Kavacha.
- c. Though ecology(cover) all species of life, the species which (occupy)
the centre of the stage (be) man, because he alone, of all species,
has set out in confrontations with nature.

5

Direct & Indirect Speech

(Reported Speech)

Note :

1. In direct speech the exact words of the speakers are put within inverted commas and a comma.
2. In Indirect speech the comma or colon and inverted commas are removed.

Rules for changing Direct Speech into Indirect Speech

Rule No. 1

If the reporting verb is in the present tense or future time the tense of the verb in the indirect speech (reported speech) does not change.

Examples:

- a) Sarala says, "I am a student." (Present)
Sarala says that she is a student.
- b) Ram says, "I will go to Bangalore tomorrow." (Future Time)
Ram says that he will go to Bangalore the next day.

Rule No. 2

If the reporting verb is in the past tense, the tense of the verb in the Indirect speech is changed into past form as detailed under:-

Direct Speech**Indirect Speech**

- | | |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------|
| a) Simple Present | Simple Past |
| b) Present Continuous | Past Continuous |
| c) Present Perfect | Past Perfect |
| d) Present Perfect continuous | Past Perfect continuous |
| e) Simple Past | Past Perfect |
| f) Past Continuous | Past perfect continuous |
| g) Past Perfect | (No change) |
| h) Past Perfect Continuous | (No change) |



For reference

Present simple

Suma said "I work hard."

Present continuous

Teacher said "I am visiting some villages."

Present perfect

They said "We have caught the thief."

Past simple

Padma said "I didn't punish him."

Past Continuous

Raju said "I was ironing my shirt in the morning."

Past Perfect

The pupil said "I had forgotten to bring my text book."

Past Simple (I D)

Suma said that she worked hard.

Past continuous

Teacher said that he was visiting some villages.

Past Perfect

They said that they had caught the thief.

Past Perfect

Padma said that she had not punished him.

Past Perfect Continuous

Raju said that he had been ironing his shirt in the morning.

Remains Same

The pupil said that he had forgotten to bring his text book.

Examples According to the Tense Forms Mentioned Above

a) Andy said to the Mayor, "I don't want to be troublesome."

Andy told the Mayor that he didn't want to be troublesome.

b) Farmer said, "I am sowing boiled beans to get a rich crop."

Farmer said that he was sowing boiled beans to get a rich crop.

c) The king said, "Where has all your wit gone, my dear ministers?"

The king asked his dear ministers where all their wit had gone.

d) Madam said, "I have been teaching English for ten years."

Madam said that she had been teaching English for ten years.

e) Sheela said, "Mr. Ajay paid only four pence for his letter."

Sheela said that Mr. Ajay had paid only four pence for his letter.

f) He said, "I was working here last year."

He said that he had been working there the previous year.

g) Sarala said to her friends, "I had not forgotten my school."

Sarala told her friends that she had not forgotten her school.

h) My father said to me, "I had been serving in the education department since 1980."

My father told me that he had been serving in the education department since 1980.

List of important words which are to be changed into other forms while changing direct speech into indirect speech

Direct Speech

A. Personal Pronouns

I

Me

My/mine

We

Our/ ours

You

Your /yours

He, she, it they

Yourself

Yourselves

Indirect Speech

(According to the gender & number)

he or she

him or her

his or her / hers

they

their / theirs

he, she, him, her, they / them

his, her, their or theirs

remain unchanged

himself / herself

themselves

B. Adverbs or demonstratives

DS (Direct Speech)

Today

Tomorrow

Tonight

Yesterday

Last week

Next week

Now

Here

IDS (Indirect Speech)

that day

the next day

that night

the previous day

the previous week

the following week

then

there



This	that
These	those
Thus	so or in that way
Ago	before
Sir/madam	respectfully

C. Verbs (when the reporting verb is in the past tense)

Am /is	was
Are	was or were (Depending on the number)
Was	had been
Were	had been
Has / have	had
Can	could
Will	would
Shall	should /would
May	might
Must	(no change)
See / sees	saw
Saw	had seen
do /does	did (as main verb)
Do not / does not / don't	did not or didn't
Did not /didn't	had not or hadn't
Do look / does look	looked (in the questions)
Did look	had looked (in the questions)
Did not look	had not looked
Didn't look	hadn't looked
Look / looks	looked
Meet /meets	met

1. Assertive Sentences (, “=that) (said to =told)

- 1) Andy said to the postmaster, “I want a letter, sir, if you please.” (Direct Speech) Andy told the post master respectfully that he wanted a letter, if he pleased. (Indirect speech)
- 2) Andy said to the postmaster, “you'll never see me again If I have my way.”
Andy told the postmaster that he would never see him again if he had his way.
- 3) The postmaster said to Andy, “I won't give you any letter unless I know you're his servant.”
The postmaster told Andy that he wouldn't give him any letter unless he knew he was his servant.
- 4) Andy said to the postmaster, “It's not everyone who is as ignorant as you.”
Andy told the postmaster that it was not everyone who was as ignorant as he.
- 5) The postmaster said to Andy, “you've to pay me eleven pence postage.”
The postmaster demanded Andy that he had to pay him eleven pence postage.
- 6) The squire said to Andy, “You'll provoke me to break your neck someday.”
The squire told (Warned) Andy that he would provoke him to break his neck someday.
- 7) Andy said to the postmaster, “He'll murder me If I'm not back soon.”
Andy told the postmaster that he would murder him if he was not back soon.
- 8) Chandrasekhar said to the author, “I have a passion for the game. That led me to persevere.”
Chandrasekhar told the author that he had a passion for the game and that had led him to persevere.
- 9) The farmer said to Daksha, “The king has sent the eggs with me, for you, to hatch.”
The farmer told Daksha that the king had sent the eggs with him, for her, to hatch.
- 10) The king said, “My whole kingdom is proud of you, pretty lady.”
The king told the pretty lady that his whole kingdom was proud of her.

II. Imperative Sentences (, “ = to / not to)

- 1) “Ride into the town and see if there's a letter for me,” said the squire to Andy.
The squire ordered Andy to ride into the town and see if there was a letter for him.
- 2) The squire said to Andy, “Go to the post office and ask for a letter for me.”
The squire ordered Andy to go to the post office and ask for a letter for him.



- 3) Dr. Sarabhai said to the student, "Don't worry, we'll buy another one."
Dr. Sarabhai consoled the student not to worry and told that they would buy another one.
- 4) Sachin Tendulkar said to the young cricketers, "Have an aim in life. Work hard with dedication."
Sachin Tendulkar advised the young cricketers to have an aim in life and to work hard with dedication.
- 5) He said to the cricketers, "Come to the field alive and play cricket."
He advised to the cricketers to go to the field alive and play cricket.
- 6) The King said to minister "Please present the problem to this august gathering of the chosen intellectual of my kingdom."

Note:-

The King requested minister to present the problem to that august gathering of the chosen intellectual of his kingdom. 1. Said to = ordered / commanded / advised

2. Said to "Please = requested"

III. Interrogative sentences.

(Said to = asked / Questioned / enquired)

a) Yes / No type questions. (," = if)

- 1) The squire said to Andy "Do you know where to go in the town?"
The squire asked Andy if he knew where to go in the town.
- 2) Andy said to the postmaster "Is it squire Egan you dare to say goose?"
Andy questioned the postmaster if it was squire Egan he dared to say goose.
- 3) Durfy said to the postmaster "Have you one for me?"
Durfy asked the postmaster if he had one for him.
- 4) Narendranath said to Sri Ramakrishna "Have you seen God?"
Narendranath asked Sri Ramakrishna if he had seen God.
- 5) Daksha said "Father, did the king talk to all who you went with?"
Daksha asked her father if the king had talked to all who he had gone with.
(Or he had been with)


b) 'wh' question (, “= ____)

- 1) The postmaster said to Andy, “Who do you want it (a letter) for?”
The postmaster asked (enquired) Andy who he wanted it (a letter) for.
- 2) Andy said to the postmaster, “What should I pay eleven pence for?”
Andy asked the postmaster what he should pay eleven pence for.
- 3) Author said to B. S. Chandrasekhar, “Which is your toughest match?”
Author enquired with B. S. Chandrasekhar which his toughest test match was.
- 4) The author asked B. S. Chandrasekhar, “What's your advice to the young cricketers?”
The author asked B. S. Chandrasekhar what his advice to the young cricketers was.
- 5) Daksha said, “Dear father, what nice thing did you have to give to the king?”
Daksha asked her dear father what nice thing he had to give to the king.
- 6) Daksha said, “Dear father, how did you think of visiting the king wearing such dusty clothes?”
Daksha asked her dear father how he had thought of visiting the king wearing such dusty clothes.
- 7) The king said, “What are you doing, lady?”
The king asked the lady what she was doing.

Exclamatory sentences (, “= that)

Said to = exclaimed

- 1) Passerby – 2 said, “He sows boiled beans to reap a rich crop, how ridiculous!”
Passerby -2 said that he sowed boiled beans to reap a rich crop and exclaimed that it was ridiculous.
- 2) Passerby – 3 said, “How stupid of him to say that”.
Passerby – 3 exclaimed that it was very stupid of him to say that.
- 3) The king said, “Oh! How clever this lady!”
The king exclaimed that the lady was very clever.
- 4) He said, “What an interesting play Shakuntala is!”
He exclaimed that Shakunthala was a very interesting play.

**Change into indirect speech:**

1. She says, "I am a doctor."

.....

2. The teacher says, "I am punctual."

.....

3. The boy said, "I go to school to learn."

.....

4. The Prime Minister said, "It gives me great pleasure to be here this morning."

.....

5. They said, "We did not make mistakes."

.....

6. Mr. Shakar said, "I do not know what made me say it."

.....

7. The inspector said to Mr. Reddy, "I shall visit your college as soon as possible."

.....

8. I said to him, "You have taken my wallet."

.....

9. She said to me, "You did not admit your mistakes."

.....

10. He said to her, "I bought these books yesterday."

.....

11. I said, "I care not a fig for him."

.....

12. He said, "Ram, take that object away."

.....

13. He said to me, "What do you want?"

.....

14. Krishna said, "Kala, have you written the assignment ?"

.....



15. "Have you done your project?" said the teacher to the students.

.....

16. "Did you take medicine as per my instructions?" said the doctor to the patient.

.....

17. "Avoid bad company, Mohan." Said the father.

.....

18. The leader said, "Farewell, my countrymen."

.....

19. He said to me, "I have run a thorn into my foot."

.....

20. She said to me, "Oh! You are here."

.....

Change the conversation to narrative form/reported speech

Exercise 1

Dave : Hello, my name is David. It's nice to meet you.

John : Hi, I'm John. It's my pleasure to meet you.

Dave : I'm sorry, what is your name, again?

John : John.

Dave : So Jenny, What do you do for a living?

John : I work at the local school teaching English. What do you do for a living?

Dave : I'm also an English teacher, but I am currently out of work.

John : Sorry to hear that. It has been really nice talking to you.

Dave : Yes. It was a great pleasure meeting you.

Ans:

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

**Exercise 2**

- Bobby : Hi Jason, it's great to see you again.
- Jaison : Wow, it's great seeing you, how long has it been? It must be more than 6 months. I'm doing well. How about you?
- Bobby : Not too bad.
- Jaison : What movie are you and the family going to watch?
- Bobby : I came here to watch the Simpsons movie. How about you?
- Jaison : I'm going to watch Terminator 4.

Ans:

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Exercise 3

- Susan : Leslie, may I borrow your cell phone to call my mother after we finish lunch?
- Lesi : Yes, of course, Jane. And please, do not forget to ask your mother whether you may go to the movies with us afterwards.
- Mary : Jane, could you pass the salt, please?
- Susan : Sure, here you are.
- Mary : Thank you.
- Susan : You are welcome.
- Lesi : Would both of you mind if I stop by Marcus bookstore on our way to the movie?
- Susan : No, not at all.
- Mary : I would love to look at their New Book selection. So, I would like to stop there also.
- Susan : Would both of you like to go for shopping after the movie?
- Lesi : Maybe some other time. I need to be at home by 5 o'clock.



- Mary : I can go with you if you want.
- Susan : That would be great. I need to pick up a gift for my brother. His birthday is on Sunday next week. What would you recommend, Mary?
- Mary : Just a moment please. Let me think. May be a fishing pole since he loves fishing?
- Susan : What a clever suggestion! My brother will thank me for the lovely gift. I hope there is a fishing store in the mall.
- Lesi : I ordered too many French fries. Would anybody care for some?
- Susan : Yes, I would like some.
- Lesi : How about you, Mary?
- Mary : No, thank you. I have enough food already.
- Susan : Leslie, would you like some of my fried rice?
- Lesi : Yes, please. Just a little bit.
- Susan : Here you go.
- Lesi : Oh, that is enough! No more, please.
- Susan : Mary, did you remember to bring my Harry Potter book?
- Mary : Oh, I am sorry. I completely forgot about it. Could you call to remind me again tonight?
- Susan : Certainly.
- Lesi : If you do not mind, may I borrow the book after you are done with it?
- Susan : I promised to let John borrow it after I get it back from Mary. You are welcome to have it once John is finished. John is a fast reader; he will finish it in no time.
- Lesi : I, on the other hand, am a pretty slow reader. How long do you think I may keep it?
- Susan : I already read it. So, you may keep it as long as you want. Give it back to me at your earliest convenience.
- Lesi : Thank you, Jane. That will save me some money.
- Mary : Are we all done? We should leave now to catch the next show; otherwise, we will be late.
- Lesi : I am ready anytime you are.
- Susan : So am I. Shall we go?

6

Active and Passive Voice

Read the following sentences;-

- 1) John planted a tree.
- 2) A tree was planted by John.

We can see that both the sentences express the same meaning. But in Sentence (1) the subject (John) is the doer of the action; so the verb (planted) is said to be in **Active Voice**.

A verb is in the active voice when the subject is the doer of the action.

In sentence (2) the subject (the tree) is the receiver of the action; so the verb (was planted) is said to be in the **Passive Voice**.

A verb is in the passive voice when the subject is the receiver of the action.

Note:-

The passive voice is so called because the person denoted by the subject is not active but passive. He / She is the sufferer or beneficiary.

Rules for changing the sentences from active voice to the passive voice

1. Only Transitive verbs which take objects can be used in the passive voice, because an intransitive verb does not take any object.
While changing active voice into passive voice the object of a verb in the active voice becomes the subject of the passive voice.
2. A. Active voice is used to make the agent or the doer of the action prominent.
B. Passive voice is used to make the sufferer or the receiver prominent.
3. The object of the passive voice is followed by the preposition 'by' when the agent is known.
4. Past participle form of the verb is used in the passive voice.

Examples are given according to the tense forms.

1. Simple present tense

(When the object is singular in the active voice)

Examples:-

1. Active voice: Hari helps me.
Passive voice: I am helped by Hari.



2. I give him a book (When there are two objects)

Passive voice: He is given a book by me.

Or

A book is given to him by me.

3. Mohan advised her.

Passive voice: She is advised by Mohan.

Sentence pattern in the Passive voice:

Subject + be form + past participle + by + object

1) I + am + helped + by + Hari

2) He / She / It + is + past participle + by + object

3) I + am + past participle + by + object

2. Simple Present Tense

(When the object is plural in the active voice)

Examples:

1. Our teacher teaches us lessons. (Two objects)

Passive voice: a) We are taught lessons by our teacher.

Or

Lessons are taught to us by our teacher.

2. We learn lessons

Passive voice: Lessons are learnt by us.

Sentence Pattern:

Subject + Verb + Past participle + by + object

We / you / they + are + past participle + by + object

3) Present continuous

(When the object is singular in the active voice)

Examples:

- 1) I am telling a story.

Passive Voice: A story is being told by me.

**Sentence Pattern:**

Subject + Verb + Past participle + by +object

I + am being + past participle + by + object

He / She / It + is being + past participle + by + object

4) Present Continuous Tense

(When the object is plural in the active voice)

Examples:**1) We are learning many lessons.**

Passive voice: Many lessons are being learnt by us.

Sentence Pattern:

Subject + Verb + Past participle + by +object

We / you / they +are being + past participle +by +object

5) Present Perfect Tense

(When the object is singular in the active voice)

Examples:

1) I have given him a book (with two objects)

Passive Voice: He has been given a book by me.

Or

2) A book has been given to him by me.

They have praised me for my good deeds.

Passive Voice: I have been praised for my good deeds by them.

Sentence Pattern

Subject + Verb + Past participle + by +object

I + have been + past participle + by + object

He / She / It + has been + past participle + by + object

6. Present Perfect Tense

(When the object is plural in the active voice)

**Examples:**

- 1) Teachers have taught us poems (with two objects)

Passive Voice: We have been taught poems by teachers.

Or

Poems have been taught to us by teachers.

Sentence Pattern

Subject + Verb + Past participle + by + object

We / you / they + have been + past participle + by + object

7. Simple Tense

(When the object is singular in the active voice)

Examples:

1. Vikram carried out research on cosmic rays.

(Passive Voice) Research on cosmic rays was carried out by Vikram.

2. A research student burnt up an electric meter.

Passive Voice: An electric meter was burnt up by a research student.

3. Dr. Sarabhai realized the importance of industries in India.

Passive Voice: The importance of industries in India was realized by Dr. Sarabhai.

4. He created a new chapter in India's space age.

Passive Voice: A new chapter was created in India's space age by him.

Sentence Pattern

Subject + Verb + Past participle + by + object

I / He / She / It + was + past participle + by + object

8. Simple Past Tense

(When the object is plural in the active voice)

1. Andy pulled out three letters from his packet.

Passive Voice: Three letters were pulled out from his packet by Andy.

2. Dr. Sarabhai sent many of them abroad.

Passive voice: Many of them were sent abroad by Dr. Sarabhai.

3. Dr. Sarabhai sent them abroad.

Passive voice: They were sent abroad by Dr. Sarabhai.



4. The teacher saw the students talking in the class.

Passive voice: The students were seen talking in the class by the teacher.

Sentence Pattern

Subject + Verb + Past participle + by +object

We / you / they +were + past participle +by +object

9. Past Continuous

(When the object is singular in the active voice)

Examples:

1. **Raju was doing his work sincerely.**

Passive Voice: His work was being done sincerely by Raju.

2. **She was singing a song melodiously.**

Passive Voice: A song was being sung melodiously by her.

Sentence Pattern

I / He / She / It + was +being + past participle + by + object

10. Past Continuous

(When the object is singular in the active voice)

Examples:

1. Mohan was drawing pictures neatly.

Passive Voice: Pictures were being drawn neatly by Mohan.

2. Sarala was telling stories with great interest.

Passive Voice: Stories were being told with great interest by Sarala.

Sentence Pattern

We / you / they +were +being + past participle +by +object

- 11) Past Perfect

(When the object is singular in the active voice)

Examples:

1. Daksha had solved the problem.

Passive Voice: The problem had been solved by Daksha.

2. The farmer had taken mangoes

Passive Voice: Mangoes had been taken by the farmer.



Sentence Pattern

Subject + Verb + Past participle + by + object

I / We / You / He / She / It / They + had been + past participle + by + object

12) Modal Auxiliaries

(When the object is singular in the active voice)

Examples:

1. We should not cheat others.

Passive Voice: Others should not be cheated by us.

2. Raju can sing a song.

Passive Voice: A song can be sung by Raju.

Sentence Pattern

Subject + Modal Aux + be + past participle + by + object

I Will

We Would

You Shall

He Should + Be + past participle + by + object

She May

It Might

Note:

No passive voice in the present perfect continuous and in the past perfect continuous tense.

Changing an Imperative Sentence into the Passive Sentences which express request, order, advice, suggestion, prohibition etc., are called

imperative sentences.

The imperative sentence in the passive voice has the following structure:

Let + object + be + past participle

When the active voice begins with do not, the passive voice has the following structure:

Let not + object + be + past participle

In some sentences it is possible to put **not** after the object or be.

**Examples:**

Active : Bring it home.

Passive : Let it be brought home.

Active : Do it at once.

Passive : Let it be done at once.

Active : Do not beat the dog.

Passive : Let the dog not be beaten.

Active : Let me do it.

Passive : Let it be done by me. OR Let me be allowed to do it.

You can begin the sentence with you if **you** want to put emphasis on the person addressed to.

Examples :

Active : Please help me.

Passive : Let me be helped.

Passive : You are requested to help me.

Active : Don't touch it.

Passive : Let it not be touched.

Active : You are warned not to touch it.

The passive form has to begin with you, when the object of the verb in the active voice is not given.

Active : Work hard. (No object)

Passive : You are advised to work hard.

Active : Get out. (No object)

Passive : You are ordered to get out.

Active : Please lend me some money.

Passive : You are requested to lend me some money.

Active : Kindly do this work.

Passive : You are requested to do this work.

Active : Get me a glass of water.

Passive : You are ordered to get me a glass of water.

Active : Let us go for a walk.



Passive : It is suggested that we should go out for a walk.

In sentences where God is invoked the passive voice will be as follows:

Active : May God bless you!

Passive : May you be blessed by God!

Changing an Interrogative Sentence into the Passive

Read the following sentences:

Active : Do the children play football?

Passive : Is football played by the children? (NOT Do football played by the children?)

Active : Did Ram invite you?

Passive : Were you invited by Ram? (NOT Did you invited by Ram?)

Note:

As you may have noticed, the auxiliaries do, does and did are not used in the passive.

Active : Have you finished the work?

Passive : Has the work been finished by you?

Note : The auxiliaries has, have and had are used in the passive, but they change their form according to the number and person of the passive subject.

Active : Can anyone cure it?

Passive : Can it be cured?

Active : Will he accept our invitation?

Passive : Will our invitation be accepted by him?

Note:

The auxiliaries can, may, will and shall do not change their beginning position when active voice is changed into the passive voice.

Active : Whom did you laugh at?

Passive : Who was laughed at by you?

Active : Who killed the snake?

Passive : By whom was the snake killed?

**Note:**

Who changes to **by whom** in the passive; (by) whom changes to who in the passive.

Active : Why did he punish you?

Passive : Why were you punished by him?

Note:

The question words **when, where, why, how** and **what** do not change their beginning position when the sentence is changed from the active to the passive.

Change the following imperative and interrogative sentences into passive voice :

1. Carry it home.

Ans.

2. Do it at once.

Ans.

3. Write a letter to your mother.

Ans.

4. Do not cut the trees.

Ans.

5. Work hard.

Ans.

6. Open the door.

Ans.

7. Please bring me a pen.

Ans.

8. Who teaches you English ?

Ans.

9. Did he catch the last train ?

Ans.

10. Can anybody cure Ebola ?

Ans.



11. Why did he punish you ?

Ans.

12. When will the university announce the result ?

Ans.

13. Have you finished the word ?

Ans.

14. Who killed the rabbit ?

Ans.

15. Do the children play cricket ?

Ans.

16. Did John invite you ?

Ans.

17. What does this box contain ?

Ans.

LIST OF CHANGES

(In respect of personal pronouns)

Active Voice

Passive Voice

I	me
We	us
You	you
He	him
She	her
It	it
They	them

Change into passive voice:

1. Brutus killed Caesar.

Ans.

2. He writes a letter.

Ans.



3. He speaks the truth.

Ans.

4. They did the work.

Ans.

5. She sang a song.

Ans.

6. Narayan sells sugar.

Ans.

7. He threw stones at his shop.

Ans.

8. He lodged a complaint against Ravi.

Ans.

9. They play football every day.

Ans.

10. She gave me a book.

Ans.

11. He narrated the students a story.

Ans.

12. The policeman has arrested him.

Ans.

13. He invited Shekar to his house.

Ans.

14. We can carry on the mass production.

Ans.

15. Who wrote the book?

Ans.

**Fill in the blanks with passive form verbs:**

1. Socrates became popular. Some politicians began to accuse him of corrupting the youth. He(try) by the Assembly of the people. When he (ask) to defend himself, he said that the accusers had hardly spoken the truth.
2. There was a time when the water of the Ganga (consider) so pure that people stored it in sealed containers. Today the water of this very same river (pollute) and is no longer safe for drinking purpose.
3. John..... (greet) with joy. A bicycle pump(direct) at him and a jet of soot black water (squirt) into his eyes. After clearing his eyes he blinked and looked at the group of boys and girls who cheered and danced in front of him.
4. Holi(celebrate) for two to five days. On the first day large fires (light) everywhere and people worship them to mark the end of evil in land.
5. If we pile up all the rubbish that(throw) out by people all over the world, we can easily build one Mount Everest every year. Half this waste(make) up of mineral and industrial wastes.

Simple Present		Present or Past Continuousing	Simple Past tense	Past Participle Has /have had
I, We You, They	He, She, It			
1	2	3	4	5
Act	Acts	Acting	Acted	Acted
Advise	Advises	Advising	Advised	Advised
Beat	Beats	Beating	Beat	Beaten
Begin	Begins	Beginning	Began	begun
Bend	Bends	Bending	Bent	Bent
Bear	Bears	Bearing	Bore	Borne
Believe	Believes	Believing	Believed	Believed
Bite	Bites	Biting	Bit	Bitten
Blame	Blames	Blaming	Blamed	Blamed
Break	Breaks	Breaking	Broke	Broken
Bring	Bring	Bringing	Brought	Brought
Build	Builds	Building	Built	Built
Burn	Burns	Burning	Burnt	Burnt
Buy	Buys	Buying	Bought	Bought
Catch	Catches	Catching	Caught	Caught
Cut	Cuts	Cutting	Cut	Cut
Do	Does	Doing	Did	Done
Draw	Draws	Drawing	Drew	Drawn
Dream	Dreams	Dreaming	Dreamt	Dreamt
Drink	Drinks	Drinking	Drank	Drunk
Drive	Drives	Driving	Drove	Driven



Simple Present		Present or Past Continuousing	Simple Past tense	Past Participle Has /have had
I, We You, They	He, She, It			
1	2	3	4	5
Earn	Earns	Earning	Earned	Earned
Eat	Eats	Eating	Ate	Eaten
Feed	Feeds	Feeding	Fed	Fed
Feel	feels	feeling	Felt	Felt
Find	Finds	Finding	Found	found
Forget	Forgets	Forgetting	forget	Forgotten
Get	Gets	Getting	Got	Got
Give	Gives	Giving	Gave	Given
Grow	Grows	Growing	Grew	Grown
Hang	Hangs	Hanging	Hanged	Hanged
Hear	Hears	Hearing	Heard	Heard
Hide	Hides	Hiding	Hid	Hidden
Hold	Holds	Holding	Held	Held
Hurt	Hurts	Hurting	Hurt	Hurt
Keep	Keeps	Keeping	Kept	Kept
Know	Knows	Knowing	Knew	Known
Lead	Leads	Leading	Led	Led
Learn	Learns	Learning	Learnt	Learned
Leave	Leaves	Leaving	Left	Left
Lend	Lends	Lending	Lent	Lent
Lose	Loses	Losing	Lost	Lost
Make	Makes	Making	Made	Made
Meet	Meets	Meeting	Met	Met
Pay	Pays	Paying	Paid	Paid
Put	Puts	Putting	Put	Put
Read	Reads	Reading	Read	Read
Ride	Rides	Riding	Rode	Ridden

Simple Present		Present or Past Continuousing	Simple Past tense	Past Participle Has /have had
I, We You, They	He, She, It			
1	2	3	4	5
Say	Says	Saying	Said	Said
See	Sees	Seeing	Saw	Seen
Sell	Sells	Selling	Sold	Sold
Send	Sends	Sending	Sent	Sent
Shake	Shakes	Shaking	Shook	Shaken
Shoot	Shoots	Shooting	Shot	Shot
Show	Shows	Showing	Showed	Shown
Shut	Shuts	Shutting	Shut	Shut
Sing	Sings	Singing	Sand	Sung
Sow	Sows	Sowing	Sowed	Sowed
Speak	Speaks	Speaking	Spoke	Spoken
Spend	Spends	Spending	Spent	Spent
Spell	Spells	Spelling	Spelt	Spelt
Spread	Spreads	Spreading	Spread	Spread
Steal	Steals	Stealing	Stole	Stolen
Stop	Stops	Stopping	Stopped	Stopped
Study	Studies	Studying	Studies	Studies
Swear	Swears	Swearing	Swore	Sworn
Take	Takes	Taking	Took	Taken
Teach	teaches	Teaching	Taught	Taught
Tear(V)	Tears	Tearing	Tore	Torn
Tell	Tells	Telling	Told	Told
Think	Thinks	Thinking	Thought	Thought
Throw	Throws	Throwing	Threw	Thrown



Simple Present		Present or Past Continuousing	Simple Past tense	Past Participle Has /have had
I, We You, They	He, She, It			
1	2	3	4	5
Wear	Wears	Wearing	Wore	Worn
Weep	Weeps	Weeping	Wept	Wept
Win	Wins	Winning	Won	Won
Wind	Winds	Winding	Wound	Wound
Write	Writes	Writing	Wrote	Written
Stand	Stands	Standing	Stood	Stood
Sit	Sits	Sitting	Sat	Sat
Go	Goes	Going	Went	Gone
Clap	Claps	Clapping	Clapped	Clapped
Sleep	Sleeps	Sleeping	slept	Slept
Come	Comes	Coming	Came	Come
Live	Lives	Living	Lived	Lived
Bind	Binds	Binding	Bound	Bound
Blow	Blows	Blowing	Blew	Blown
Choose	Chooses	Choosing	Chose	Chosen
Dig	Digs	Digging	Dug	Dug
Deal	Deals	Dealing	Dealt	Dealt
Fail	Falls	Falling	Fell	Fallen
Fly	Fly's	Flying	Flew	Flown
Grind	Grinds	Grinding	Ground	Ground
Ring	Rings	Ringing	Rang	Rung
Run	Runs	Running	Ran	Run

7

Prepositions

“It may be noted, however, that the idiosyncrasy of English, like that of other languages is perhaps most strikingly exemplified in the use of Preposition”.

Words showing the position of the noun or pronoun are called Prepositions. It tells where the subject/ object is in a sentence.

1. There is a box **on** the table.

2. We go **by** train

3. The minister is angry **with** me.

- In the first sentence 'on' shows the relation between box and table.
- In the second 'by' shows the relation between 'go' and 'train'
- In last sentence 'with' shows the relation between 'angry' and 'me'

KINDS OF PREPOSITIONS

Prepositions are broadly classified in the following categories

1. **Simple or single word preposition:** as, on, in, at, by, for, from, off, etc.
2. **Compound preposition:** as, beside, between, beyond, inside, outside, within, without, etc.
3. **Phrase prepositions:** as, in front of, in spite of, in order to, owing to, for the sake of, in the course of, with regards to, etc.
4. **Participle prepositions:** as, barring, concerning, considering, regarding, etc. Such words are present participles: they have come to be used as prepositions; as, Pending further instructions, you are transferred to the regional office.

RELATIONS SHOWN BY PREPOSITIONS

Time -> at, on, before, from, to till, for, after, in, by during.

At, in, on

These are used in respect of time

a) At, in and on: with respect to time

I. At is used to indicate a point of time; as,

We see you **at** 10 o' clock.

They began their journey **at** sunset.



II. We also use 'at' to indicate holiday period of two or three days; as, at Christmas, at the weekend, etc.

- I. 'In' is used to indicate longer periods; as, in the next few days, in the summer holidays in July
- II. We also use 'in' to indicate a part of the day; as, in the afternoon, in the morning 'In time' means not late; as, Make sure you are at the station in time for the train.
'on time' means at the arranged time (not before, not after); as,
The 7:30 train started on time.

1. Gopal goes **to** office **at** 10.00 a.m.
2. Latha was **in** Mumbai **on** 10th June.
3. Hari left the house **before** sunrise.
4. Government offices work **from** 9.30 **to** 6.00 p.m.
5. Please wait **till** tomorrow.
6. The minister stayed **in** London **for** a week.

Place -> behind, across, in, at, among, on

At, in and on: in respect of place

- I. We use 'at' to indicate something with reference to a point in space; as Someone is knocking at the door.
- II. We use 'at' + 'building' when we are talking about the normal purpose of the building; e.g.,
She is still at school (studying)
Mini is at the theatre. (Watching a film)
- III. 'At' is used for small and less important places, villages and small towns; 'in' is used for large places, countries and large towns; as, He lives at Moga in Punjab.
He works in Kolkata in India.

Ex:

1. She stood **behind** the door.
2. They ran **across** the road.
3. Mr. John was **in** London.



Correct use of some important Prepositions At, in

'At' is used for villages, towns, a smaller locality, address, etc. 'In' is used for large towns, large localities, cities, state, countries.

- 1) Mhathma Gandhi was born at Porbander in Gujarat
- 2) Mr. David lives in Africa

Beside, besides,

Beside means by the side of

Besides means in addition to

- a) The Principal sat beside the student.
- b) Besides being punished he was also fined.

On time, in time

'on time' means at the arranged exact time neither before nor after

'In time' means not late

1. the plane started on time.
2. Pupils should go to school in time.

Above, over

'Above' and 'Over' means higher in rank 'Above' Can mean 'higher than', 'Over' can mean 'more than' or 'higher than'

1. The sky is over our heads.
2. Ravi is over fifty.
3. The applicant must be above the age of twenty.

From, of

'From' shows exact place of starting or exact time of starting

'Of' doesn't shows exact place or time

An apple fell **of** the tree. (✓)

An apple fell **from** the tree. (X)

I am calling from Chennai.

Till, Until, by

We use 'till, until' to say when something finishes; as,

He sat in the shop **till/until** closing time.

'Till' means up to by means not later than



- a) Children waited for chief guest till 3.00 p.m.
- b) The chief guest may come by 2.00 p.m.

Below, under Both can mean lower than sometimes either can be used interchangeably

- a) I live in the 3rd floor my friend lives in the floor below.
- b) The river flows under the bridge.

On, Upon

'On' is usually used while speaking of things at rest; and 'upon', denotes in motion; as,

- a) She sat on a sofa.
- b) The tiger pounced upon the deer.

In, Into

'In' denotes position or a state of rest inside something. 'Into' denotes motion towards the inside of something; as,

- a) The fish is in the water.
- b) Mohan jumped into the swimming pool.

In, within

'In' denotes 'at the end of some future period'; 'within' means 'before the end of'; as

- a) I will return in (at the close of) a month
- b) I will return within (in less than) a month.

For, since, ago

We use **for** with a period of time:

- a) I stayed in Delhi for a week.
- b) Please wait for five minutes.

We use **since** with the perfect tense to say when something started; as,

- a) I have lived here since 1985.
- b) I haven't met her since September.

Between, among

'Between' is used with two persons or things; as

- a) Divide the bananas between the two children.
- b) A dispute arose between the landlord and the tenant.



'Among' is used with more than two persons or things; as,

- a) The four sisters quarreled among themselves.
- b) There is said to be an understanding among thieves.

Fill in the blanks with suitable prepositions:

- 1. He was born Ramnagar, a village Karnataka.
- 2. Divide this the two of you.
- 3. She died cholera.
- 4. He is fond children.
- 5. She has no taste music.
- 6. The road was built the N.S.S. students.
- 7. She belongs a noble family.
- 8. An ideal citizen abides The laws of the country.
- 9. They were charged murder.
- 10. He has been suffering cancer Sunday last.
- 11. India does rely any foreign advice plan.
- 12. Did she prevent you coming here?
- 13. All kinds articles are available the market.
- 14. Please send the doctor.
- 15. I am your disposal.
- 16. The actor killed the deer a gun.
- 17. The boy takes no interest studies.
- 18. The lion pounced the jackal.
- 19. Divide this work four parts.
- 20. I differ you this matter.
- 21. Give your bad habits.
- 22. Beware pickpockets.
- 23. We should not depend others.
- 24. I prefer tea coffee.
- 25. They are suspicious Your movements.
- 26. Open your book page two.



27. Look..... the blackboard.
28. He has great sympathy the poor.
29. I shall talk to him this matter.
30. what use is it?
31. He is an expert duping everybody.
32. Be content what you have.
33. There is no bus; we will have to go foot.
34. This is the book I was telling you.....
35. The cat sprang the table.

Fill in the blanks with suitable prepositions choosing from the ones given in the brackets:

1. The butcher had kept the money bag him. (beside/besides)
2. The Director will interview the candidates 10 and 11.30 a.m. (from/between)
3. They have been waiting here two days. (since/for)
4. As Som fell debt, he decided to sell his house and live a hut. (in/into)
5. The land is ploughed him the help of a tractor. (by/with)
6. They put a blanket..... him. (over/above)
7. He put the book her. (below/under)
8. doing cooking she helps her husband. (beside/besides)
9. He kept the book the table. (upon/on)
10. Shankar goes to Mysore everyday Saturday. (but/ expect)
11. The ship sailed the ocean. (across/through)
12. The 6 p.m. Rajdhani Express started exactly at 6 p.m. (on time/ in time)
13. My friend lives Japan. (at/in)
14. We live No. 55, Patel Road. (in/at)
15. The horse is the stable. (in/at)
16. The boy ran to her mother. (into/to)



17. Don't go that room. (in/into)
18. There is a flower vase the table. (upon/on)
19. You can't climb that high roof. (on/upon)
20. She'll be there 5 o' clock. (till/since)
21. I haven't seen a movie March. (from/since)
22. The doctor will be here 10 a.m. onwards. (from/since)
23. I sat Sham and his brother. (among/between)
24. He is his friends. (among/between)
25. He has been here four years. (since/for)

Fill in the blanks with suitable prepositions:

1. London city was overtaken a serious pollution problem the December 1952.
2. Bheem completed his primary education Satara and started going school along his elder brother. He developed passion reading.
3. Marching right the English army. Joan struck terror the hearts the enemy soldiers.
4. The British ruled India nearly two hundred years. They were 'foreigners'.
5. Ravi's mother was suffering Cancer. He was very anxious her health. He decided to consult a good doctor friend his.



8

Articles

Note: The adjectives 'a' or 'an' and 'the' are usually called articles. They are also called demonstrative adjectives.

There are two kinds of articles namely.

1. Indefinite article. (a or an)
2. Definite article. (the)
- 1) '**A**' or '**An**' is called the indefinite article because it leaves indefinite the person, place, animal or thing we speak about. It is used before a common noun, singular number.
- 2) '**The**' is called the definite article because it points out some particular, person, place, animal or thing.

USES OF ARTICLES

- 1) The definite article 'A' is used:-

(a) Before a word beginning with a consonant sound **E.g.: a book, a horse, a boy, a hole,**

a chain, a school, etc.

(b) Before certain words with initial vowel letter which is pronounced as a consonant sound 'yu' a **European, a university, a union, a useful metal, a unicorn, a one rupee note, a one eyed man.**

(c) In the sense of 'one'

1. Twelve inches make a foot.
2. A bird in the hand is worth two in the bush.
3. He did not utter a word.

(d) In the sense of any

1. A cow is a useful animal.

- 2) The indefinite article 'an' is used:-

(a) before a word beginning with a vowel sound (a,e,i,o,u) an orange, an umbrella, an ass, an enemy, an ink bottle, an elephant, an ox, an eye, an ink pot.

(b) before certain words which begin with initial consonant letter but their sound is of vowel an honorable man, an hour, an honest man, a heir, a historical novel, (the initial



letter 'h' is not pronounced)

3) The definite article 'The' is used:-

(a) Before a particular person or thing already referred:

E.g.: 1. The man had come to my house whom we met last month.

2. Before the names of very important gulfs, rivers seas, etc. The Persian gulf, The Ganges, The Red Sea, The Indian Ocean, The British Isles, The Himalayas, The Alps, The Sahara, The Kaveri, The Atlantic Ocean, The Baltic sea.

3. Before singular noun which represents a whole class.

- a) The cow is a useful animal.
- b) The rose is a beautiful flower.
- c) The banyan is a kind of fig tree.
- d) The horse is a noble animal.
- e) The cat loves comfort.

4. Before the names of sacred books or newspapers. The Vedas, The Puranas, The Ramayan, The Indian Express, The Hindu.

5. Before the names of things unique of the kind. The sun, The Sky, The earth, The moon, The universe.

6. Before the superlative e.g. : the wisest, the best student, the highest peak.

7. Before the national communities. The Hindus, the English, the Burmese. the Muslims, the French.

8. Before the ordinal numbers: The First World War, The third round.

9. Before musical instrument: The flute, the violin, etc.

10. Before an adjective when the noun is understood.

- a) We should not look down upon the poor.
- b) The rich can buy anything they need.

11. Before a proper noun only when it is qualified by an adjective.

- a) The immortal Shakespeare.
- b) The great Caesar.

12. As an adverb with comparative.

- a) The more we get, the more we want.
- b) The higher we go, the cooler we feel.



Omission Of Articles

The article is omitted

1. Before a common noun in its widest sense.
 - a) Man is mortal
2. Before names of materials
 - a) Iron is more useful than gold.
 - b) Cotton is grown in India and America
3. Before proper nouns.
 - a) Bangalore is a big city.
 - b) Gandhiji is the father of our nation.
4. Before abstract noun.
 - a) Honesty brings us reward
 - b) Wisdom is the gift of heaven
5. Before languages.
 - a) Kannada is our mother tongue
6. Before school, college, church, bed, table, hospital, market, prison

Note: When these places are visited for their primary purpose, no article is used before them.

Examples:

- a) Students go to school (to study)
- b) Christians go to church on Sundays (to pray)
- c) I go to bed at 9 -00 p.m. (to sleep)
- d) My friend is still in hospital (as a patient)

Note: 'The' is used with these words when we refer to them as a place to be visited with some other purpose instead of primary purpose.

Examples:

- a) My father had come to the school to meet the headmaster.
- b) He went to the church to meet his friend.
- c) I went to the bed to see the baby sleeping.
- d) I went to the hospital to see my friend.



7. Before names of relation like – father, mother, aunt, uncle, cook and nurse. (no article is used)

8. In the phrases like –

- a) By bus, by messenger, by plane, by car
- b) To catch fire, to send word, to lose heart, to give ear
- c) At home, in debt, at night, at sight, on demand, at noon, on foot, at ease etc., (No article is used)

5) Repetition Of The Article

Read the sentence:-

- 1) I have a black and white shirt.
- 2) I have a black and a white shirt.

The first sentence means that I have only one shirt which is partly black and partly white.

The second sentence means that I have two shirts one is black and the other is white.

Note:

1. When two or more adjectives qualify the same noun, we must use only one article before the first adjective.
2. When two or more adjectives qualify the different nouns, we must use the article before each adjective.

Fill in the blanks with a, an, or the:

1. One goes to university to receive higher education.
2. Honesty is best policy.
3. English is interesting language.
4. camel is ship of the desert.
5. The Ganga is polluted river.
6. He was unconscious for hour and a half.
7. My friend who is honest man is union leader too.
8. Morning walk is tonic for weak and Cure for..... sick.
9. It is always safer not to call even fool Ass.



10. Drinking tea is ritual that is taken very seriously indeed byJapanese.
11. I always speak truth.
12. She is..... European.
13. Earth moves round sun.
14. Gold is precious metal.
15. Both sisters are intelligent.
16. I have pen and book.
17. Put table in the room.
18. Jai told me secret of his success.
19. man walked down village road, from his clothes everybody know that man was from strange country.
20. The lorry struck tree; you can still see huge scars on tree.

9

Conjunctions/Linkers

A conjunction joins two words, phrases, clauses and sentences.

Examples:

1. Rahul **and** Ramesh are friends.
2. Rahul is strong **but** Ramesh is weak.
3. You will get First Class **if** you work hard

1. Co-ordinating Conjunctions:

Conjunctions which join clauses of equal rank are called Co-ordinating Conjunctions.

- (a) They saw the summit **but** the ascent was very steep.
- (b) That boy was very naughty **yet** he is very intelligent
- (c) I don't like that woman **nor** I ever respect her.

Note: The Co-ordinating Conjunctions but, yet, nor connect the clauses together. These clauses have meaning independent of each other.

2. Correlative Conjunctions

Correlative conjunctions are like tag-team conjunctions. They come in pairs, and you have to use both of them in different places in a sentence to make them work. They get their name from the fact that they work together (co-) and relate one sentence element to another. Correlative conjunctions include pairs like “both/and,” “whether/or,” “either/or,” “neither/nor,” “not/but” and “not only/but also.”

- a. I want **either** the cheesecake **or** the frozen hot chocolate.
- b. I'll have **both** the cheesecake **and** the frozen hot chocolate.
- c. I didn't know **whether** you'd want the cheesecake **or** the frozen hot chocolate, so I got you both.
- d. Oh, you want **neither** the cheesecake **nor** the frozen hot chocolate? No problem.
- e. I'll eat them both - **not only** the cheesecake **but also** the frozen hot chocolate.

3. Compound Conjunctions

There are groups of words that take on the role of Co ordinating Conjunctions.

- a. The Principal **as well** as his wife joined the students in their party.
- b. The commuters got off the bus **as soon** as it came to stop.



4. Subordinating Conjunctions

The most commonly used Subordinating Conjunctions are: when, while, where, though, if, unless, till, after, before, because, as and that:

- a. The girls began to laugh **when** the teacher went out.
- b. The students were listening **while** the teacher was explaining the chapter.
- c. They shall meet **where** the road turns right.
- d. The old lady walked fast **though** her legs were aching.
- e. The world will come to end **if** there is nuclear warfare.
- f. She will not get that job **unless** she learns interpersonal skills.
- g. The child cried **till** it was given milk.
- h. There was silence **after** the students left the ground.
- i. It doesn't rain **until** summer gets very hot.
- j. The boy didn't come to college **because** he was not well.

Note: The clauses introduced by the Subordinating Conjunctions do not convey complete sense with one clause; each clause depends on another clause.

The following are few examples:

- a. When the teacher went out.
- b. While the teacher was explaining the chapter.

These clauses depend on the earlier clause known as the Principal Clause. The clauses introduced by Subordinating Conjunctions are known as Subordinating Clauses.

Exercise I

1. He wants the chocolates the cake.
2. He said that he would like to have both the chocolates the cake.
3. You can have the cake the ice cream .
4. He ate..... the chocolates the ice cream .
5. He smokesdrinks.



Exercise II

1. Rahul.....Ramesh are friends.
2. Rahul is strongRamesh is weak.
3. You will get first class you work hard.
4. I will drink coffee tea.
5. Rajesh studies wellhe passed the examination in first class.
6. Kumar is a singer a dancer.
7. Gopal is a doctor a teacher.
8. I can wither buy a site a built house.
9. cat is away, the mice will play.
10. I would rather die beg his favour.
11. He runs he had been shot.
12. I returned home the sun had set.
13. She wept so much she fell ill.
14. Wisdom is better rubies.
15. you sow, so shall you reap.
16. We had scarcely reached the school it started raining.
17. He harmed me, I will not harm him.
18. He talks he were mad.
19. This is the fact I know.
20.he fails, what will he do?
21. Even it rains, I shall go to my office.
22. We will go you go.
23. We eat we may live.



10

Punctuation

The word Punctuation comes from the Latin word 'punctum' meaning a point. Punctuation helps to make the meaning of a passage clear by helping the reader to take groups of words as meaningful portions for comprehension. There are ten Punctuation marks.

1. Full stop (.)
2. Comma (,)
3. Interrogative/ Question mark (?)
4. Exclamatory mark (!)
5. Quotation mark (" ")
6. Apostrophe (')
7. Hyphen (-)
8. Colon (:))
9. Semi-colon (;)
10. Brackets ()

Full stop (.)

It represents the longest pause.

1. It indicates the close of an Assertive or Imperative sentence:

- a. Jaipur is a beautiful city.
- b. Shut the door.

2. It is used in abbreviation and initials:

- a. Dr. Shetty is a famous person in Bangalore.
- b. Meet Mr. Atul.
- c. What are your educational qualifications?
I am an M.A., M.Ed.,
- d. She is Mrs. Kumar

Comma (,)

It indicates the shortest pause in a sentence.

1. After words of address:

- a. Come here, Raj, at once.
- b. Anu, please bring your text book.

2. To separate the items in a list made up of the same parts of speech in a sentence:

- a. He is intelligent, hardworking, clever, wise and honest.
- b. The plant bore white, purple and yellow flowers.

3. After pairs of words, or phrases of the same kind:

- a. The politician turned up and down, in and out, left and right and turned quickly.

4. When a verb has to be related the comma is used to indicate an ellipsis and avoid repetition.

- a. He went one way, she, another.
- b. Mrs. Suma is a Sindhi; Kamalabai, a Marathi.

5. Before and after a participle phrase inside a sentence:

- a. The girl, after eating fruits, went to meet a friend.
- b. The king, after hunting the tiger, returned to his palace.

6. When direct speech is about to begin:

- a. Sandra said, "I like music."
- b. She asked me, "Where is your house?"

7. Before and after words in a past participle position (addition of one word or phrase to another word or phrase as an explanation):

- a. Mahatma Gandhi, the Father of our nation, was assassinated by Godse.
- Interrogation/Question Mark

1. After 'Wh' questions:

- a. How do you come to college?

2. After 'Non-wh Questions/ question which begin with auxiliary verbs:

- b. Are you a student?

3. After a question tag:

- a. Ramayana is a famous epic, isn't it?

4. After clauses in a sentence asking questions:



- a. The judge asked a series of question: "Did you not steal? Wasn't John with you?"

Exclamatory mark (!)

After the words or sentences expressing surprise, joy, pain, sorrow, or a wish

- a. What a naughty boy!
- b. How beautiful the palace is!
- c. Alas! He is no more.
- d. Oh! That I were young again.

Quotation marks (Inverted commas): (" ")

1. To enclose direct speech in a sentence:

- a. Wordsworth observes, "the world is too much with us!"
- b. "Where do you go?" she asked.

Apostrophe (')

1. In the possessive case of nouns:

- a. This is David's bag.
- b. Why do you go to St. Joseph's Evening College?

2. To mark the omission of a letter or letters:

- a. He is an hon'ble man
- b. Didn't I tell you?
- c. He'll never do the work.

Hyphen (-)

1. A short line used in the compound words:

- a. He is staying in his father-in-law's house.
- b. Some boys broke the window-pane.

Semi-colon (;)

It is a lesser stop than a full-stop. It is used between grammatically complete sentences and is not followed by a capital letter.

1. Between co-ordinate clauses, that express a contrast or repeat the first idea, more or less in another form:

- a. Sit down, pupils; he wants to say something of his plans
- b. Plants grow and live; animals grow and live and feel.

2. To give greater emphasis to various clauses:

- a. The world is dying of machinery; that is the disease; that is the plague that will sweep away and destroy civilization.

Semi-colons replacing Conjunctions:

- a. We shall compete in the tournament and win the prize.
We shall compete in the tournament; we shall win the prize.
- b. The young man wants to be a pilot, but he has a weak heart.
The young man wants to a pilot; unfortunately he has a weak heart.

COLON (:) :

The colon is used to illustrate and to explain a statement. After the colon, the illustrations need not be complete sentences. They need be only short phrases or sometimes even single words.

- a. The instructions warning the motorists were very clear: not to exceed the speed limit of 40 kilometers per hour, not to overtake other vehicles from the left, not to use horns except at the sharp turns, not to smoke while driving and not to use mobile phone while driving.
- b. The executive committee of the club unanimously decided to put into force the following: expulsion of those members defaulting payment of subscription, behavior in the club and permission of secretary for guest entry.

The following paragraphs are unpunctuated. Rewrite them using correct punctuation.

my friend hamid told rajgopal john and I that he had ten slices of toast a couple of eggs some sausages and half a litre of milk for breakfast

Ans.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

almost all of the people in charge the captain the first mate the chief petty officer and the other senior members of the crew were surprised when the news came through the ship was sinking if they had been down in the engine room they would have had a very different view of things the surprise was not that the ship was sinking but that it had ever



11

Concord or Subject Verb Agreement

In a grammatically correct and meaningful sentence, the Verb must agree with the Subject in number and person; that is, the verb should be of the same Number and Person as the Subject:

- 1. Two or more Singular Subjects (linked by 'and') take Plural Verb; as:**
 - a. Arun and Ashok are good friends.
 - b. A shopkeeper and a driver were present.
- 2. If two Singular Subjects (linked by 'and') are preceded by each other or every, the Verb is Singular; as:**
 - a. Every man and every woman was terrified.
 - b. Time and tide waits for none.
- 3. If two Subjects (joined by 'and') represent one idea, then the Verb is Singular;**
 - a. Time and tide waits for none.
 - b. Law and order is our main concern.
- 4. If two Singular Nouns refer to the same person or thing, the Verb must be Singular;**
 - a. The priest and politician has arrived. (Only one person is referred here)
 - b. The principal and the secretary have arrived. (Two persons are referred here)
- 5. Two or more Singular Subjects connected by 'or', 'nor', 'either.....or', 'neither.....nor' take a Verb in Singular;**
 - a. Neither snacks nor water was to be found here.
 - b. Either Seema or Priya is there.
- 6. When the Subjects connected by 'or', 'nor', are different numbers, the Verb should be plural and the Plural Subject should be placed near the Verb;**
 - a. Either Ann or her brothers are to be praised.
 - b. Neither John nor his friends were present.



- 7. When the subjects joined by 'or', 'nor' are of different persons, the Verb agrees in person with the one nearest to it;**
- Either my sister or I must have left the box open.
 - Neither he nor I are to blame.
- 8. Either, neither, each, everyone, many, must be followed by a Verb in the Singular;**
- Everyone was present at the function.
 - Each student was given a box.
 - Either of the two leaders is knowledgeable.
 - Neither of my relatives is willing to help.
 - Many a girl is aspiring to be great.
- 9. Words joined to a singular subject by 'with', together with and not, besides, not less than, as well as, require a singular Verb**
- My brother, with my parents, returns from Delhi tomorrow.
 - The class representative, together with the students of his class, is going to meet the Principal.
 - No one, besides the minister, knows where the mischief is.
 - She, no less than her friend, is guilty.
 - The Justice, as well as advocate, allows it.
- 10. Some nouns which are plural in form, but singular in the meaning take a singular verb.**
- The news is true.
 - Politics is the last resort for some people.
- 11. When a plural noun denotes some specific quantity or amount considered as a whole, the verb generally singular.**
- Hundred paisa is equal to one rupee.
 - Five kilometers is not a long distance to walk.
 - Twenty-five thousand rupees is not much for that product.



12. A collective noun takes a singular verb when the group is thought of as a single unit. It takes a plural verb when the individuals of which it is composed are thought of.

- a. The jury has five members.
- b. The jury have five different opinions.
- c. The committee has issued report.
- d. The committee were divided on the question of revision of pay for drivers and conductors.

EXERCISE

1. One of my relatives gone to London. (have/has)
2. Everyone of the clerks applied for loan. (has/have)
3. Each man and each woman the right to live. (have/has)
4. A thousand rupee (is/are) a big sum.
5. Each of the students clever. (are/is)
6. Iron as well as gold found in India. (is/are)
7. The public requested not to walk on the grass. (is/are)
8. The army called out. (was/were)
9. Thirty years (is/are) a long time.
10. The audience getting bored. (was/were)
11. None of them right. (is/are)
12. A girl with her brother standing in the corridor. (is/are)
13. A large number of people present. (was/were)
14. My spectacles costly. (is/are)
15. Each of them (is/are) honest.
16. Honour and glory (is/are) his reward.
17. Mathematics my favourite subject. (is/are)
18. Each of the boys rewarded. (is/are)
19. Which one of these books yours. (is/are)
20. A large number of people (was/were) present.

A KEY TO CORRECT ENGLISH

1. I **had gone** to the cinema yesterday (Incorrect)
I **went** to the cinema yesterday (Correct)
(**Had gone** is the past tense. It cannot be used in the place of past tense. It can be used only to describe a past action which took place earlier than another past action).
2. I **am going** to my office every day in the bus (Incorrect)
I **go** to my office every day by bus (Correct)
(In this sentence, there are two errors.
 - i) Since it is a routine action we should use the simple present tense to describe it. So "**am going**" should be replaced by the verb "go".
 - ii) "In the bus" is Un-English. For all conveyances the appropriate preposition is "by". Idiomatically there is no need for an article. Here "**By bus**" is an idiomatic expression).
3. He is **having** a beautiful car. (Incorrect)
He **has** a beautiful car. (Correct)
(In English, the verb "to have" has no present continuous form. So in its place we should use the present indefinite form)
4. I am knowing the truth. (Incorrect)
I know the truth. (Correct)
(The verb "**Know**" does not have the present continuous tense form in English. In its place we should use the present indefinite form).
5. The teacher said that he **will** teach English tomorrow. (Incorrect)
The teacher said that he **would teach** English tomorrow. (Correct)
(Since it is indirect speech the tense of the subordinate verb should be Changed into the tense of the main verb. So instead of will teach we should use would **teach**. In indirect speech the word **tomorrow**



expressive of nearness is changed into the expression the next day expressive of distance).

6. We should always **say** the truth. (Incorrect)
We should always **speak** the truth. (Correct)
(**Say** is a physical action. **Speak** is a mental action. So, we should use the verb **Speak**).
7. He **did** the marriage of his son last year. (Incorrect)
He **performed** the marriage of his son last year. (Correct)
(**'Did the marriage'**. Is an indianism. Therefore, in this sentence **Performed** should be used in the place of **did**).
8. I have **made** a house in Bangalore. (Incorrect)
I have **built** a house in Bangalore. (Correct)
(**Made** a house is an Indianism. Instead of that we should say **built**.)
9. My father **drives** a scooter. (Incorrect)
My father **rides** a scooter. (Correct)
(**Drive** a scooter is un-English. **We ride a scooter**, is correct English.)
10. When we went to Delhi we **lived** in a hotel. (Incorrect)
When we went to Delhi we **stayed** in a hotel. (Correct)
(For temporary residence, **stay** should be used).
11. We should **refrain from** violence. (Incorrect)
We should refrain from **committing** violence. (Correct)
(The verb **refrain** must be followed by a present participle. i.e., an ing Verb).
12. I regret **for** my delay. (Incorrect)
I regret my delay. (Correct)
(The verb **regret** is transitive. It takes a direct object. It does not take a preposition).
13. The teacher entered **into** the class. (Incorrect)
The teacher **entered** the class. (Correct)
(The verb **enter**, when it means entering a place, does not take **into**. But With respect to an agreement it takes **into**.. For instance, it is correct to Say, "The two parties entered into an agreement).



14. She is ill for two weeks. (Incorrect)
She **has been** ill for two weeks. (Correct)
(Since it is a duration, we should use the present perfect tense. The Present indefinite tense shows only an action taking place daily as a Routine).
15. After the robber **has** escaped, the police arrived. (Incorrect)
After the robber **had** escaped, the police arrived. (Correct)
(The action that takes place earlier than another past action, should be described with the past perfect tense).
16. Since I could not get any conveyance, I came **by** walk. (Incorrect)
Since I could not get any conveyance, I came **on foot**. (Correct)
(The expression **by walk** is an Indianism. **By** can be only with the name of conveyance).
17. He taught **to** us correct English. (Incorrect)
He taught **us** correct English. (Correct)
(The verb teach in this context, is transitive. So **to** should be omitted).
18. We **chose** him as our leader. (Incorrect)
We **chose** him our leader. (Correct)
(The verb **chose**, being transitive, does not take as. It takes a direct object)
19. I consider him as a fool. (Incorrect)
I consider him a fool. (Correct)
(The verb consider, being transitive here, does not take as. It takes a direct object).
20. She has been appointed **as** a clerk. (Incorrect)
She has been **appointed** a clerk. (Correct)
(The verb appointed, being transitive, does not take **as**. It takes a direct object).
21. He called me **as** a fool. (Incorrect)
He called me a fool. (Correct)
(The verb called, being transitive, does not take as. It takes a direct object)
22. The member elected him **as** their leader. (Incorrect)
The member **elected** him their leader. (Correct)
(The verb elected, being transitive, does not take as. It takes a direct object)



23. We made him **as** our captain. (Incorrect)
 We **made** him our captain. (Correct)
 (The verb made, being transitive, does not take as. It takes a direct object).
24. The teacher let us to go home. (Incorrect)
 The teacher let us go home. (Correct)
 (The verbs **make**, **let** and **bid** do not take **to**, because they are followed by infinitives without the sign of the infinitive to.)
25. My father made **me** to study hard. (Incorrect)
 My father made me **study** hard. (Correct)
 (The verbs **make**, **let**, and **bid** do not to, because they are followed by infinitives without the sign of the infinitive to.)
26. The state of his affairs are deplorable. (Incorrect)
 The state of his affairs is deplorable. (Correct)
 (The subject of the sentence is **state**, not affairs. So the verb should be in the singular number).
27. Two and two **makes** four. (Incorrect)
 Two and two **make** four. (Correct)
 (Since the subject is plural, it takes plural verb)
28. R.K. Narayan has written many a story which **are** humorous. (Incorrect)
 R.K. Narayan has written many a story which is humorous. (Correct)
 (The expression **many a** is plural in sense but singular in number. Therefore it takes a singular verb.)
29. There is a large number of students in this class. (Incorrect)
 There are a large number of students in this class. (Correct)
 (In this sentence the subject is **there**, which means in this context it. It refers to number which is in the singular number).
30. The number of students in the class **are** large to control. (Incorrect)
 The number of students in the class **is** large to control. (Correct)
 (The actual subject of the sentence is number, not students. Hence it takes a singular verb).



31. The robber, with all his followers, **were** arrested by the police. (Incorrect)
The robber, with all his followers, **was** arrested by the police. (Correct)
(The subject of the sentence is robber, which is singular in number. So, It takes a singular verb).
32. Fifty rupees **are** a large sum. (Incorrect)
Fifty rupees **is** a large sum. (Correct)
(The subject of the sentence is sum, not fifty rupees. Hence it takes a singular verb).
33. The teacher as well as the students **were** absent on the day. (Incorrect)
The teacher as well as the students **was** absent on the day. (Correct)
(When we use **as well** as grammar requires that the verb should agree With the subject first mentioned).
34. Every man and every woman have the right to vote. (Incorrect)
Every man and every woman has the right to vote. (Correct)
(**Every**, inspite of repetition, signifies a singular number. It is a distributive adjective. **So** it takes a singular verb).
35. The teacher has promised yesterday that he **will** help us. (Incorrect)
The teacher has promised yesterday that he **would** help us. (Correct)
(The past tense should be used since past time is indicated).
36. The wood-cutter fell the tree **by** a sharp axe. (Incorrect)
The wood-cutter fell the tree **with** a sharp axe. (Correct)
(**Fell** is the past tense of fall. Here we require **felled** which is the past tense of fell)
37. Each of the boys **were** given a prize. (Incorrect)
Each of the boys **was** given a prize. (Correct)
(The actual subject of the sentence is **each** not **boys**. Therefore, it takes a singular verb).
38. Neither the King nor the minister **were** responsible for the mal-administration of the country. (Incorrect)
Neither the King nor the minister **was** responsible for the mal-administration of the country. (Correct)
(When we use the reciprocal conjunction, with a singular subject in both the place we should use a singular verb.)



39. It is time that government **had taken** steps to provide drinking water to this area. (Incorrect)

It is time that government **took steps** to provide drinking water to this area. (Incorrect)

(When we use the expression **it is time**, we should use only the past indefinite tense).

40. The student has done many mistakes in writing the answer. (Incorrect)

The student has **committed** many mistakes in writing the answer. (Correct)

(**To do a mistake** means **to regret an action**. Ex: 1 I did a mistake in attending the marriage because I was not given a proper treatment there.)

To make a mistake means to do something which should not have been done. Ex: I made a mistake in issuing a cheque without looking up the pass book.

To **commit a mistake** means to commit errors in composition spoken or written).

41. If **I was** the Prime Minister of India, I would give priority to education. (Incorrect)

If **I were** the Prime Minister of India, I would give priority to education. (Correct)

(**Would give**, expressive of desire, is in the subjunctive mood and so it does not take a singular past tense in the conditional clause.)

42. It is difficult to **pull** on with the new manager. (Incorrect)

It is difficult to **get** on with the new manager. (Correct)

(**Pull** on is an Indianism. We should use the English expression, get on.)

43. All the workers in the factory **sided** their leader when he made a demand for an increased wage-structure. (Incorrect)

All the workers in the factory **took sides with** their leader when he made a demand for an increased wage-structure. (Correct)

(**Sided** is an Indianism. It has to be replaced by **take sides with** which is an English idiom)

44. The river has **flown** into the sea. (Incorrect)

Present tense	Past tense	Past participle
Flow	Flowed	Flowed
Fly	Flew	Flown

The river has flowed into the sea. (Correct)



45. When I **lied** under the tree the bus passed away. (Incorrect)

When I **lay** under the tree the bus passed away. (Correct)

Present tense	Past tense	Past participle
Lie (tell a lie)	Lied	Lied
Lie (repose)	Lay	Lain
Lay (Kept)	Laid	Laid
He lies to me.		
He lied to me yesterday.		
He has lied to me.		

46. I **lay** on my bed every night. (Incorrect)

I **lie** on my bed every night. (Correct)

(**Lay** means keep in the present indefinite form).

47. Since 1980, I **am working** in this factory. (Incorrect)

I **have been working** in this factory since 1980. (Correct)

(For an action which has been taking place, we should use the present perfect continuous tense)

48. I cannot **cope up** with this work. (Incorrect)

I cannot **cope with** this work. (Correct)

(The cope with is an idiom. Therefore we should not introduce into the idiom any extra word.)

49. I always travel **in a** bus. (Incorrect)

I always travel **by** bus. (Correct)

(**By** is the appropriate preposition for all conveyances).

50. I sent the parcel **through** post. (Incorrect)

I sent the parcel **by** post. (Correct)

(**By** is the appropriate preposition in this context).



51. I always sit **besides** my friend because I can copy **from** his answers. (Incorrect)
 I always sit **beside** my friend because I can copy **from** his answers. (Correct)
 (Beside and besides are often confused. **Beside** means 'by the side of'. Besides means in addition to).
52. She **resembles** to her mother. (Incorrect)
 She **resembles** her mother. (Correct)
 (The verb resemble is transitive. So it takes a direct object)
53. My uncle lives **in the** upstairs. (Incorrect)
 My uncle lives **upstairs**. (Correct)
 (The expression **upstairs** includes the preposition **up**. So in should not be used.)
54. I am **awaiting for** your arrival. (Incorrect)
 I am **awaiting** your arrival. (Correct)
 (Waiting is an intransitive verb. So it takes **for**. **Awaiting** is transitive, so it does not take **for**.)
55. The robber jumped over the compound **wall**. (Incorrect)
 The robber jumped over the **compound**. (Correct)
 (**Compound wall** is an Indianism. Compound itself is the wall or the fence.)
56. The fruits were distributed **among** the two boys. (Incorrect)
 The fruits were distributed **between** the two boys. (Correct)
 (**Among** is used, if there are more than two persons or things. **Between** is used, if there are only two boys, persons or things.)
57. My father gave me good **advices**. (Incorrect)
 My father gave me good **advice**. (Correct)
 (**Advice** means precept. **Advices** means **information** relating to business, sales etc.)
58. We sat **seeing** the T.V. (Incorrect)
 We sat **viewing** the T.V. (Correct)
 (The correct verb for this context is **viewing** not **seeing** or **watching**).
59. He is my cousin **brother**. (Incorrect)
 He is my cousin. (Correct)
 (Cousin is **common gender** in English)



60. He accompanied me **until** the hotel (Incorrect)
He accompanied me **upto** the hotel (Correct)
(The word **until** shows time, **upto** shows distance.)
61. I believe in you. (Incorrect)
I believe you. (Correct)
(With reference to persons the verb **believe** functions as a transitive verb)
62. The teacher **accepted** to go with us. (Incorrect)
The teacher **agreed** to go with us. (Correct)
(The verb **accept** is transitive. It takes a direct object)
63. Your name is not on the **roles**. (Incorrect)
Your name is not on the **rolls**. (Correct)
(This is a case of using a wrong word misled by the similarity in pronunciation).
64. The child is **weeping** for food. (Incorrect)
The child is **crying** for food. (Correct)
(**Weeping** is not the appropriate word because it means loudly lamenting)
65. He is suffering from **stomach pain**. (Incorrect)
He is suffering from **stomach ache**. (Correct)
(The correct English expression is **stomachache** not **pain**. **Ache** implies some disorder in the functioning of the organs. **Pain** implies cut or wound)
66. He sold all his **furnitures** when he left his village. (Incorrect)
He sold all his **furniture** when he left his village. (Correct)
(The word **furniture** has no plural form).
67. We received the **informations** sent by you. (Incorrect)
We received the **information** sent by you. (Correct)
(The word **information** has no plural form)
68. This is a convenient house to **live**. (Incorrect)
This is a convenient house to **live in**. (Correct)
(We cannot live a house, we should say "**We live in** a house".
Therefore **in** is necessary)



69. There is no answer for this question. (Incorrect)
There is no answer to this question. (Correct)
(**Answer to** is the appropriate prepositional phrase)
70. Many are addicted **for** gambling. (Incorrect)
Many are addicted **to** gambling. (Correct)
(**Addicted to** is the appropriate preposition).
71. We should pray for God. (Incorrect)
We should pray to God. (Correct)
(**Pray to** is the correct expression. **To** is the appropriate preposition).
72. I know **who** you mean. (Incorrect)
I know **whom** you mean. (Correct)
(Here the objective case **whom** is necessary).
73. **The** charity begins at home. (Incorrect)
Charity begins at home. (Correct)
(Abstract nouns do not take an article if they are not qualified by a clause or a phrase)
74. They **prevented** him going. (Incorrect)
They prevented him **from** going. (Correct)
(**Prevent from** is the correct expression)
75. I am disgusted **of** city life. (Incorrect)
I am disgusted **with** city life. (Correct)
(To be **disgusted with** is the correct form).
76. I did not have no money. (Incorrect)
I did not have money. (Correct)
(The given sentence contains a **double negative**)
77. He **makes often** mistakes. (Incorrect)
He **often** mistakes. (Correct)
(**Often** which is an adverb should be placed behind the verb in this sentence).



78. What is he looking? (Incorrect)
What is he looking for? (Correct)
(The verb **look** is intransitive. So it must be followed by a preposition).
79. He always rides **on** a car. (Incorrect)
He always rides **in** a car. (Correct)
(**To ride** on a car is Indianism.)
80. The teacher said that he had visited the U.S.A. two years **ago**. (Incorrect)
The teacher said that he had visited the U.S.A. two years **before**. (Correct)
(In indirect speech, **ago** is changed to before).
81. I invited all my friends **for** a dinner. (Incorrect)
I invited all my friends **to** dinner. (Correct)
(The verb invite takes the preposition to).
82. Milk is beneficial **for** health. (Incorrect)
Milk is beneficial **to** health. (Correct)
(**To** is the appropriate preposition)
83. I came **by walk**. (Incorrect)
I came **on foot**. (Correct)
(**By** walk is non-standard English)
84. We enjoyed in the holidays. (Incorrect)
We enjoyed **ourselves** in the holidays. (Correct)
(The verb enjoy must have an object, because it is a transitive verb).
85. The teacher has no sympathy **with** me. (Incorrect)
The teacher has no sympathy **for** me. (Correct)
(**For** is the appropriate preposition)
86. **I took** bath in the river. (Incorrect)
I bathed in the river. (Correct)
(We **take a bath** to clean our body. We bath for pleasure).
87. Deepavali is **coming**. (Incorrect)
Deepavali is **approaching**. (Correct)
(The word coming in this context is an Indianism. The word **approach** is the correct English expression).



88. The rain is **coming**. (Incorrect)
 The rain is **falling**. (Correct) or It's raining.
 (The given sentence is incorrect because it is Indianised English.)
89. The teacher is angry **upon** me. (Incorrect)
 The teacher is angry **with** me. (Correct)
 (In this sentence the correct preposition is **with**.)
90. He **asked** a loan from me. (Incorrect)
 He **asked for** a loan with me. (Correct)
 (The verb **ask** is intransitive in this context. So the preposition **for** should be used.)
91. Please put your **sign** here. (Incorrect)
 Please put your **signature** here. (Correct)
 (Sign does not mean **signature**.)
92. The examination begins **from** Monday. (Incorrect)
 The examination begins **on** Monday. (Correct)
 (The same thing cannot begin on several days. It can begin only on one day.)
93. Everyone needs a house to **live**. (Incorrect)
 Everyone needs a house to **live in**. (Correct)
 (We live in a house. Here the verb **live** is intransitive)
94. I want a chair to **sit**. (Incorrect)
 I want a chair to **sit on**. (Correct)
 (The correct English expression is to **sit on a chair**. To sit in a chair is acceptable in the case of arm-chair etc.)
95. This house is built **with** bricks. (Incorrect)
 This house is built **of** bricks. (Correct)
 (**Of** is the correct preposition with the verb **waste**).
96. I have decided to **stick on** to my decision (Incorrect)
 I have decided to **stick to** my decision (Correct)
 (**Stick to** is an idiomatic expression. Therefore, other words should not be added to it.)



97. The angry mother **stared** her son. (Incorrect)
The angry mother **stared at** her son. (Correct)
(**Stared** is an intransitive verb. **So** it takes a preposition)
98. Ooty is a **worth-visiting** place. (Incorrect)
Ooty is a **place worth-visiting**. (Correct)
(**Worth-visiting** should not be used as an adjective)
99. When you **came?** (Incorrect)
When **did** you **came?** (Correct)
(The interrogative must have a helping verb and a main verb)
100. I have taken an umbrella in case it **will** rain (Incorrect)
I have taken an umbrella in case it **rains** (Correct)
(Here, the common error is to omit part of a verb)



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Composition- An Introduction

A composition is an original and complete piece of continuous writing. Right choice of topic plays an important role in making writing effective. To write a good composition –an essay, a paragraph, an article or a story- one needs to have constant regular practice in writing. Before one begins to write, it is important to think clearly and logically about the topic. To write a good composition one must be a reader of books, magazines, newspaper...

Essentials of Good Composition

A. Reading

1. You should develop the habit of reading.
2. You should read books on short stories, fiction, romance, history, biography and religion.
3. Regular reading of newspaper.
4. Reading books on grammar.

B. Observation

1. Reading is not everything. You must learn to observe men and things around you.

C. Thinking

1. You must develop the habit of thinking over the things, events, and every day happenings that you observe keenly.

Guidelines to write Good Composition

A. Your composition must be relevant and to the point.

B. You should be polite and objective

1. Use assertive tone
2. Make sure the reader's self-respect is not hurt.
3. Don't express your views strongly on religion and politics.
4. Don't use impolite remarks.

C. Use simple and lucid language

D. Write legibly



Types of Composition

- | | |
|-----------------------------|----------------|
| 1. Narrative | 2. Descriptive |
| 3. Argumentative/Discursive | 4. Expository |
| 5. Reflective | 6. Short-story |

1. Narrative:

This is generally a first person narration or a third person narrative, where a person is expected to narrate a particular event. A narrative composition is basically a sequence of events. While writing narrative composition, it is necessary to give detailed account of events as it happened. The event might be imaginative, but should be presented as if the narrator had experienced. Details of the people, the sequence of events, the atmosphere, the feeling of the narrator. Varying the syntactical pattern from time to time is very necessary to prevent from monotonous. Also a variety of linkers like, however, consequently, afterwards, etc., should be used frequently at regular intervals.

2. Descriptive:

A descriptive composition normally describes people, scenes or events. The main objective of the descriptive composition is to draw a clear picture of a person, place or event, as a writer visualizes it, with the help of appropriate vocabulary. A vibrant and lively description is always preferred. While describing a person or a place a detailed description is very essential. Make use of five senses- sight, hearing, smell, touch and taste to make descriptive more appealing. Avoid using vague adjectives like, 'good', 'bad', 'wonderful'. Avoid meaningless details and be careful not stray from the main theme.

3. An argumentative composition is generally a debatable topic where the student is expected to arrive at conclusion through reasoning. It is necessary for the student to express his/her opinions regarding a controversial subject; so clear, logical and coherent thinking is necessary. Most of the argumentative essay demands a definite point of view (either for or against). Support your arguments with facts and reasons.

The following qualities are expected in an argumentative writing:

- A genuine interest in writing on the topic
- The ability to see both sides of the argument
- The ability to present clear conclusion
- One point should lead logically to another
- Give arguments and examples to substantiate your views

The tone of an essay should be assertive but not aggressive. The essay should not get into controversy. Do not make strong statements. Avoid destructive criticism.



4. Expository:

This is a formal, serious essay which asks the candidate to describe all he or she knows about the topic which is expressed. Expository writing is writing that seeks to explain, illuminate or expose (which is where the word, 'expository' comes from). This type of writing can include essays, newspaper and magazine articles, instruction manuals, textbooks, encyclopedia articles, and other forms of writing, so long as they seek to explain. Expository writing differs from other forms of writing, such as fiction and poetry. In fact, this lesson itself is an example of expository writing.

The expository essay is a tool that is often used in the academic world. If you've attended school, it's highly likely you've written one. Most expository essays have an introductory paragraph, in which a thesis or objective is stated; several main body paragraphs that prove or explain what is in the introduction; and a concluding paragraph in which everything is summed up. When writing an expository essay, it's important to write with the assumption that your audience has little to no background knowledge about the main topic. Your duty as the writer is to provide the reader with as much information as you can. The reader should feel as if he or she has learned something after reading your essay.

5. Reflective:

In a reflective essay a student is expected to express his/her views, feelings, thoughts and opinions about the topic. Reflection is a mental process. It is contemplation or a long consideration. Thoughts or opinions that come to you while you are reflecting are called reflections. Unlike a reflection in a mirror, it is an interpretation of what is going on between learning and thinking. Reflective writing is evidence of reflective thinking. In an academic context, reflective thinking usually involves:

1. looking back at something (often an event, i.e. something that happened, but it could also be an idea or object).

6. Short Story:

Writing a short story is very different from writing a paragraph. The short story is a brief fictional prose that is shorter than a novel and that usually deals with only few characters. The short story is usually concerned with a single effect conveyed in only one or a few significant episodes or scenes. The good short story must have the following:

- Title
- Originality
- Title
- Plot
- Character

BUSINESS LETTER WRITING

Business letters are the life-breath of business. A business letter is usually a letter from one company to another, or between such organizations and their customers, clients and other external parties. Business letters can have many types of contents, for example to request direct information or action from another party, to order supplies from a supplier, to point out a mistake by the letter's recipient, to reply directly to a request, or to convey goodwill. A business letter is sometimes useful because it produces a permanent written record, and may be taken more seriously by the recipient than other forms of communication.

ESSENTIALS OF GOOD BUSINESS LETTER

A. Correctness

1. The grammar and punctuation need to be according to the standard usage.
2. Many letters get wisely rejected on account of the errors they contain because to send a wrongly worded or addressed letter is to invite embarrassment.

B. Completeness

1. Enough time and attention needs to be given to make the contents complete in order to fulfil the intent of the letter.
2. Editing and comprehensive thinking is required for this purpose.

C. Clarity

1. The letter should be free from all ambiguity.
2. Long paragraph and uncommon words, dead phrases and foreign language words reduce the clarity of a letter.

D. Conciseness

1. Conciseness or brevity is brought into letter writing at two levels : matter and language.
2. All extraneous information needs to be removed from the letter.



E. Courtesy

1. To be courteous is to be friendly in attitude and in the use of words.
2. Apart from basic courtesies like saying 'Dear Sir' and 'Yours sincerely' there are other courtesies that endear a letter to its receiver like 'Thanks for your letter...' or 'To set the record correct, we may submit that...'

F. Consideration

A 'You attitude' letter generates a more positive response. The expressions like 'You will happy to know...'

FORMATS OF A BUSINESS LETTER

1. FULL BLOCK
2. MODIFIED BLOCK
3. SEMI-BLOCK OR INDENTED

Formats of a Business Letter

1. Full Block form

It follows open punctuation (i.e. absence of commas in the inside address, salutation, formal close, etc.), and is very easy for the typist. Every paragraph begins flush with the left margin. This style is popular in America and adopted by many business houses in India. Every line, including the date and the complimentary close, begins at the left margin.



Job applications should be written in this format.

ABC Corporation

1, MG Road, Bangalore -01

15 March 2015

The Manager

Shri Sons & Ltd.

Bangalore - 67

Dear Sir

Subject : Supply of Raincoats and Umbrellas

We understand that you are distributors of raincoats and umbrellas of reputed companies. We deal in these goods and shall be glad to have your catalogue for them. A visit by your sales personnel will be specially appreciated.

If your terms of sale are found suitable, we can offer you business worth Rs. 20,00,00 in the forthcoming season.

We shall be happy to have an early reply.

Yours faithfully

For ABC Corporation



2. Modified Block Format

This style is a modification of the full block form where some of the parts are moved to the right, and some punctuation marks are added to the inside address, salutation and complimentary close. All the paragraphs begin at the left margin, and there is a double space between the paragraphs. This is the most popular form as it has the most of the advantages of the full block form without its disadvantages. Its appearance is balanced and neat.

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3. Semi-block (Indented) Format

It is like the Modified block form. The only difference is that the beginning of every paragraph is indented three to five spaces from the left margin. This style is getting outdated rapidly.

Types of Business letters

The aim of business letters is to increase one's business prospects, and hence tact and persuasive power is used in writing them.

A classification of business letters is given below :

- i) Job applications
- ii) Enquires and replies
- iii) Quotations, estimates and tender notices
- iv) Order, circular , notices
- v) Sales letters
- vi) Complaints (claims) and replies (adjustments)
- vii) Goodwill letters – greetings, thanks, congratulations etc.
- viii) Credit and status enquiries

EXERCISES:

1. Write a job application for the position of assistant account in a reputed firm.
2. Write a letter to the P.F. Commissioner requesting him to sanction loan on your P.F. account.
3. Make an enquiry with a manufacturer of furniture for the purchase of furniture for your college office.
4. Draft a circular for an immediate meeting of team-leaders.
5. Your cellphone postpaid bill shows overbilling. Complain, showing evidence and seek temporary as well as a permanent solution.

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